SUMMARY OF FUNDING 2023/24

Organisation Name: 10017220 Co Ltd **UKPRN:** 10017220

Master Contract Number: ESFA-196002

	Allocation			
	Contract Ref	**Aug 23 - Mar 24**	**Apr 24 - Jul 24**	**2023/24 Total**
Advanced Learner Loans Facility	ALLF-45522	£23,201	£6,799	£30,000
Advanced Learner Loans Bursary	ALLB-13263	£21,898	£18,102	£40,000
			Total Funding for this contract:	**£70,000**

Education & Skills
Funding Agency

Agreement Type	Conditions of Funding (Grant) (Employers)
Funding Period	1st August 2023 to 31st July 2024
Between	the Secretary of State for Education
And	10017220 Co Ltd
Funding for	Advanced Learner Loans
Master Agreement Number	ESFA-196002

ACCEPTANCE BY THE EMPLOYER
BY ACCEPTING THIS AGREEMENT VIA THE MANAGE YOUR EDUCATION & SKILLS FUNDING SERVICE THE PERSON TAKING THIS ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE EMPLOYER REPRESENTS AND WARRANTS THAT THE EMPLOYER HAS READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS AGREEMENT, THE EMPLOYER AGREES TO BE BOUND BY THIS AGREEMENT AND THAT HE/SHE IS DULY AUTHORISED TO ACCEPT THIS AGREEMENT AND LEGALLY BIND THE EMPLOYER.

SIGNED FOR AND ON BEHALF OF
THE SECRETARY OF STATE FOR EDUCATION
by David Withey, Chief Executive of the Education and Skills Funding Agency



This Agreement is made on the date the Agreement is digitally signed by the Employer on the Manage Your Education & Skills Funding Service between:

10017220 Co Ltd 301 Histon Road Cambridge CB4 3NF Company No: AA017220	AND	THE SECRETARY OF STATE FOR EDUCATION DEPARTMENT FOR EDUCATION 20 GREAT SMITH STREET LONDON SW1P 3BT
Hereinafter called the Employer		Hereinafter called the Department

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PART 1: PRELIMINARIES

1 DEFINITIONS

"Account Manager"	the person appointed by the Employer in accordance with Clause 16.2 (Account Manager);
"Agreement"	means the Agreement between the above named parties consisting of these Terms and Conditions, the specification and any other documents (or parts thereof) specified in the Agreement and any variations to the Agreement agreed in writing and signed by both Parties;
"Agreement Date"	The date of this Agreement;
"Agreement Manager"	the person appointed by the Department in accordance with Clause 16.1 (Agreement Manager);
"Agreement Period"	means the period between the Agreement Date and the Expiry Date, unless terminated earlier on the Termination Date;
"Apprenticeship"	means the training and (where applicable) end point assessment for an employee as part of a job with an accompanying skills development programme;
"Apprenticeship Accountability Framework"	means the framework set out by the Department at Apprenticeship training provider accountability framework - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) that includes quality indicators and supplementary indicators to which the Employer must adhere as updated and amended from time to time;
"ASBO"	an anti-social behaviour order as defined in the Crime and Disorder Act 1998;
"Awarding Organisation"	an organisation that is regulated by Ofqual or is recognised by QAA as an access validating agency;
"Barred List"	means the list of individuals who are barred from engaging in regulated activity with children, adults or both in England and Wales maintained by the Disclosure and Barring Service;
"Brokerage"	means the provision by a third party of services, for a fee, to source Sub-Contractors to provide the Services on behalf of the Employer;

“Business Continuity Plan”	any plan prepared pursuant to Clause 4.1 (Business Continuity), as may be amended from time to time;
“Change”	any change to the Services as advised by the Department;
“Child” or “Children”	shall have the meaning given to it in Section 60 of the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006;
“Combined Authority”	means an authority established under section 103(1) of the Local Democracy, Economic Development and Construction Act 2009 or an authority to which a delegation of the Secretary of State’s functions has been made under section 39A of the Greater London Authority Act 1999;
“Confidential Information”	means any information, including Personal Data as defined by the Data Protection Legislation, and any information, however it is conveyed, that relates to the business, affairs, developments, trade secrets, know-how, personnel, and suppliers of the Parties including all IPRs, together with all information derived from any of the above, and any other information clearly designated as being confidential or which ought reasonably be considered to be confidential (whether or not it is marked "confidential");
“Contracts Finder”	means the Government’s publishing portal for public sector procurement opportunities;
“Convictions”	other than for minor road traffic offences, any previous or pending prosecutions, convictions, cautions and binding over orders (including any spent convictions as contemplated by section 1(1) of the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 by virtue of the exemptions specified in Part II of Schedule 1 of the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 (Exemptions) Order 1975 (SI 1975/1023) or any replacement or amendment to that Order, or is a Barred person in accordance with section 3 of the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006;
“Crown Body”	means any department, office or agency of the Crown, including Ofsted, the Care Quality Commission, the Charity Commission, the Office for Students, Ofqual, any and all local authority or Combined Authority bodies;
“Data"	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;

“Database”	the rights in or to the data held in the Employer’s system in accordance with the Specification;
“Data Controller”	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
“Data Loss Event”	any event that results, or may result, in unauthorised access to Personal Data held by the Data Processor under this Agreement, and/or actual or potential loss and/or destruction of Personal Data in breach of this Agreement, including any Personal Data Breach;
“Data Processor”	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
“Data Processor Personnel”	means all directors, officers, employees, agents, consultants and contractors of the Data Processor and/or of any Data Sub-Processor engaged in the performance of its obligations under this Agreement;
“Data Protection Impact Assessment”	an assessment by the Data Controller of the impact of the envisaged processing on the protection of Personal Data;
“Data Protection Legislation”	(i) the UK GDPR as amended from time to time; (ii) the Data Protection Act 2018 as amended from time to time; (iii) Regulations made under the Data Protection Act 2018; and (iv) all applicable Law about the Processing of Personal Data;
“Data Protection Officer”	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
“Data Subject”, “Process” and “Processing”	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
“Data Subject Access Request” (SAR or DSAR)	a request made by, or on behalf of, a Data Subject in accordance with rights granted pursuant to the Data Protection Legislation to access their Personal Data;
“Data Sub-Processor”	any third Party appointed to process Personal Data on behalf of the Data Processor related to this Agreement;
“Department”	means the Secretary of State for Education acting through the Department for Education and / or Education and Skills Funding Agency (ESFA) as appropriate;

"Department Data"	means any data (including metadata), record, document or information howsoever stored which is either: (a) communicated by the Department, its staff, Sub-Contractors and agents to the Employer in writing, orally, electronically or by any other means relating to the Learners and/or Services provided to the Learners; or (b) is obtained, gleaned, compiled or processed by the Employer during the course of the Employer providing the Services relating to or provided to the Learners, including Personal Data for which the Department is the Data Controller including but not limited to ILR Data, e-portfolios and learner files;
"Department Policies"	the policies of the Department referred to in Schedule 7 (Security & Department Policies) and any other policies of the Department including but not limited to the Department's policy on funding higher risk organisations and Sub-Contractors in force as at the Agreement Date and amended from time to time;
"Department Related Party"	means any officer, agent, worker, employee of the Department acting in the course of their office, engagement or employment in relation to the Services;
"Department System"	means the Department's computing environment (consisting of hardware, software and/or telecommunications networks or equipment) used by the Department or the Employer in connection with this Agreement which is owned by or licensed to the Department by a third party and which interfaces with the Employer System or which is necessary for the Department to receive the Services;
"Disclosure and Barring Service" or "DBS"	means the non-departmental public body established pursuant to the Protection of Freedoms Act 2012;
"Dispute Resolution Procedure"	Means the procedure for resolving disputes as set out in Clause 17 (Dispute Resolution);
"DPA 2018"	Data Protection Act 2018;

"Earnings Adjustment Statement"	means Earnings adjustment statement (EAS) - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) as updated and amended from time to time;
"Employer Personnel"	means all persons employed or engaged by the Employer together with the Employer's servants, agents, consultants and Sub-Contractors (and all persons employed by any Sub-Contractor together with the Sub-Contractor's servants, consultants, agents, Employer's and Sub-Contractors) used in the performance of its obligations under this Agreement;
"Employer Related Party"	means any officer, agent, employee of the Employer acting in the course of their office or employment including any Sub-Contractors supplied by the Employer in relation to the Services;
"Employer System"	the information and communications technology system used by the Employer in performing the Services including the Employer's equipment and related cabling (but excluding the Department System);
"Employment Regulations"	means the Transfer of Undertakings (Protection of Employment) Regulations 2006 (SI 2006/246) as amended or replaced or any other Regulation implementing the Acquired Rights Directive 77/187/EC;
"Exempt Information"	means any information or class of information (including but not limited to any document, report, Agreement or other material containing information) relating to this Agreement or otherwise relating to the Employer, which potentially falls within an exemption to FOIA (as set out therein);
"Exemption Case"	means the case submitted by the Employer to the Department in accordance with "Subcontracting threshold and exemption cases" of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules for permission to exceed the Sub-Contracting Threshold;
"Expiry Date"	means 31 October 2024;
"Financial Year"	means a period of 12 months starting on 1 April and ending on 31 March;
"FOIA"	means the Freedom of Information Act 2000 and all

	regulations made thereunder from time to time or any superseding or amending enactment and regulations, and words and expressions defined in the FOIA shall have the same meaning in Clause 23 (Freedom of Information and Confidentiality);
"FOIA Notice"	means a decision notice, enforcement notice and/or an information notice;
"Funding"	means the funding paid to the Employer by the Department in accordance with this Agreement and the Funding Rules for the delivery of the Services;
"Funding Agreement"	means the table as set out in Schedule 2 (Payment);
"Funding Higher Risk Organisations Policy"	means the policy described in Schedule 9: Sub-Contracting and available at Funding higher risk organisations and subcontractors policy - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Funding Period"	means the period set out on page 1 of this Agreement.
"Funding Rules"	means the documents produced by the Department which set out the detailed requirements with which the Employer must comply in respect of the Services delivered under this Agreement as may be amended by the Department from time to time and as referred to in the Specification (Schedule 1).
"Funding Stream"	means each stream of Funding as set out in Schedule 2 (Payment);
"Funding Year"	means a period of 12 months starting on 1 August and ending on 31 July;
"Future Transferring Employees"	those employees of the Employer and/or the Employer's Sub-Contractors to whom the Employment Regulations will apply on the Service Transfer Date;
"Good Industry Practice"	means the exercise of that degree of skill, care, prudence, efficiency, foresight and timeliness as would be expected from a leading company within the relevant industry or business sector;
"Guidance"	any applicable guidance or directions with which the Employer is bound to comply;
"High Needs	means a Learner aged 16 to 18 with high levels of

Learner”	Special Educational Needs and Disability (SEND), supported with top-up funding from the high needs budget, or any young person aged up to 25 subject to an Education Health and Care Plan, who requires additional support costing over £6,000;
“ICT Environment”	means the Department System and the Employer System;
“Incident Response Plan”	means each Party’s operational plan for response to and recovery from Significant Incidents or Emergencies as identified in national, local and community risk registers and in accordance with the requirements of the Civil Contingencies Act 2004;
“Indirect Losses”	means loss of profits, loss of production, loss of business, loss of business opportunity, or any claim for consequential loss or for indirect loss of any nature;
“ILR” or “Individualised Learner Record”	means the on-going collection of Learner data undertaken by training providers including the Employer in the Further Education (FE) and Skills sector as set out at Individualised Learner Record (ILR) - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk);
“ILR Data”	means Individualised Learner Record data;
“Insolvency Event”	means, in respect of the Employer: (a) a proposal is made for a voluntary arrangement within Part I of the Insolvency Act 1986 or of any other composition scheme or arrangement with, or assignment for the benefit of, its creditors; or (b) a shareholders' meeting is convened for the purpose of considering a resolution that it be wound up or a resolution for its winding-up is passed (other than as part of, and exclusively for the purpose of, a bona fide reconstruction or amalgamation); or (c) a petition is presented for its winding up (which is not dismissed within 14 Working Days of its service) or an application is made for the appointment of a provisional liquidator or a creditors' meeting is convened pursuant to section 98 of the Insolvency Act 1986; or (d) a receiver, administrative receiver or similar officer is appointed over the whole or any

	part of its business or assets; or (e) an application order is made either for the appointment of an administrator or for an administration order, an administrator is appointed, or notice of intention to appoint an administrator is given; or (f) it is or becomes insolvent within the meaning of section 123 of the Insolvency Act 1986; or (g) being a "small company" within the meaning of section 382(3) of the Companies Act 2006, a moratorium comes into force pursuant to Schedule A1 of the Insolvency Act 1986;
"Inspectorates"	means one, any or all of the inspectorates: Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills (Ofsted), His Majesty's Inspectorate for Education and Training in Wales (Estyn), the Quality Assurance Agency for Higher Education, the Office for Students, the Care Quality Commission (CQC) and the Local Government Ombudsman;
"Intellectual Property Rights"	means any patent, registered design, copyright, database right, design right, topography right, trade mark, trade name, application to register any of the aforementioned rights, trade secret, inventions, right in unpatented know-how, right of confidence and any other intellectual or industrial property right of any nature whatsoever in any part of the world including, without limitation: (a) any renewals, revisions and extensions created or provided by the laws of any country; (b) all rights of action and remedies (including but not limited to an injunction, damages and/or an account of profits) in relation to past infringements; and (c) the right to apply for registration of any such rights in any country of the world;
"Law"	any law, statute, subordinate legislation within the meaning of Section 21(1) of the Interpretation Act 1978, bye-law, right within the meaning of Section 4(1) EU Withdrawal Act 2018 as amended by EU (Withdrawal Agreement) Act 2020, regulation, order, regulatory policy, mandatory guidance or code of practice, judgment of a relevant court of law, or directives or requirements of any regulatory body

	with which the Employer is bound to comply;
"Learner"	means any third party including any student, apprentice (under an Apprenticeship), trainee or similar to whom the Employer is required to deliver any of the Services;
"Learner Files" / "Learner Records" / "Evidence Packs"	means any information relating to a Learner generated by the Employer, the Learner or a third party for the purpose of the delivery of the Learning Programme;
"Learning Programme"	means a programme of education and/or training delivered by the Employer under this Agreement;
"Local Enterprise Partnership (LEP)"	means a legal relationship between two or more local authorities by way of partnership or otherwise, created for the purposes of identifying, determining and facilitating economic opportunities that generate economic growth, prosperity and job creation in a particular area;
"Malicious Software"	any software program or code intended to destroy, interfere with, corrupt, or cause undesired effects on program files, data or other information, executable code or application software macros, whether or not its operation is immediate or delayed, and whether the malicious software is introduced wilfully, negligently or without knowledge of its existence;
"Occasion of Tax Non-Compliance"	(a) any tax return of the Employer submitted to a Relevant Tax Authority on or after 1 October 2012 is found on or after 1 April 2013 to be incorrect as a result of: (i) a Relevant Tax Authority successfully challenging the Employer under the General Anti-Abuse Rule or the Halifax Abuse Principle or under any tax rules or legislation that have an effect equivalent or similar to the General Anti-Abuse Rule or the Halifax Abuse Principle; (ii) the failure of an avoidance scheme which the Employer was involved in, and which was, or should have been, notified to a Relevant Tax Authority under the DOTAS or any equivalent or similar regime; and/or (b) any tax return of the Employer submitted to a

	Relevant Tax Authority on or after 1 October 2012 gives rise on or after 1 April 2013 to a criminal conviction in any jurisdiction for tax related offences which is not spent at the Agreement Date or to a civil penalty for fraud or evasion;
"Offender Manager"	means an officer from His Majesty's Prison and Probation Service who is working directly with an offender serving their sentence in the community;
"Ofsted"	means the Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills;
"Ofsted Monitoring Visit"	means an interim type of inspection carried out by Ofsted in accordance with the Further Education and Skills Inspection Handbook (Further education and skills inspection handbook - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk))
"Parties"	means the Department acting on behalf of the Crown and the Employer;
"Personal Data"	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
"Personal Data Breach"	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
"Personal Data Requiring Sensitive Processing"	takes the meaning given in the UK GDPR;
"Premises"	means the location(s) where the Services are to be performed;
"Prohibited Acts"	means the acts specified in Clause 33 (Prohibited Acts);
"Protective Measures"	appropriate technical and organisational measures which may include: pseudonymising and encrypting Personal Data, ensuring confidentiality, integrity, availability and resilience of systems and services, ensuring that availability of and access to Personal Data can be restored in a timely manner after an incident, and regularly assessing and evaluating the effectiveness of such measures adopted by it including those outlined in this Agreement;
"Register of Apprenticeship Training Providers"	means the register maintained by the Department of organisations qualified to receive Funding from the Department to deliver Apprenticeships.

"Regulated Qualification Framework" or "RQF"	A system for cataloguing all qualifications regulated by Ofqual;
"Regulatory Body"	means those government departments and regulatory, statutory and other entities, committees, ombudsmen and bodies which, whether under statute, rules, regulations, codes of practice or otherwise, are entitled to regulate or investigate the matters dealt with in this Agreement or any other affairs of the Employer or the Department, including, without limitation Ofsted, the European Commission and the European Court of Auditors;
"Relevant Authority"	any court with the relevant jurisdiction and any local, national or supra-national agency, inspectorate, minister, ministry, officer or public or statutory person of the Government of the United Kingdom or of the European Union;
"Restricted Transfer"	a transfer of Personal Data which is undergoing processing or which is intended to be processed after transfer, to a country or territory to which such transfer is prohibited or subject to any requirement to take additional steps to adequately protect the Personal Data processed under this Agreement; for the transfer to be lawful under the Data Protection Legislation;
"Service Transfer"	any transfer of the Services (or any part of the Services), for whatever reason, from the Employer or any Sub-Contractor to a Successor Employer;
"Service Transfer Date"	the date of a Service Transfer or, if more than one, the date of the relevant Service Transfer as the context requires;
"Services"	means the services to be provided in accordance with the Funding Rules and the Specification (Schedule 1);
"Services Start Date"	means the date as set out in the Specification (Schedule 1);
"Significant Incident or Emergency"	an event or occurrence which: (i) constitutes an emergency for the purposes of the Civil Contingencies Act 2004; and/or

	(ii) constitutes an emergency under local and community risk registers; and/or (iii) is designated as a significant or emergency incident under the Incident Response Plan;
"SME"	means an enterprise falling within the category of micro, small and medium-sized enterprises defined by the Commission Recommendation of 6 May 2003 concerning the definition of micro, small and medium-sized enterprises;
"Specification"	means the documents contained in Schedule 1 setting out the Department's requirements for the Services to be provided under this Agreement;
"Staffing Information"	in relation to all persons identified on the Supplier's Provisional Supplier Personnel List or Supplier's Final Supplier Personnel List, as the case may be, such information as the Department may reasonably request (subject to all applicable provisions of the DPA), but including in an anonymised format: (a) their ages, dates of commencement of employment or engagement, gender and place of work; (b) details of whether they are employed, self employed contractors or consultants, agency workers or otherwise; (c) the identity of the employer or relevant contracting Party; (d) their relevant contractual notice periods and any other terms relating to termination of employment, including redundancy procedures, and redundancy payments; (e) their wages, salaries, bonuses and profit sharing arrangements as applicable; (f) details of other employment-related benefits, including (without limitation) medical insurance, life assurance, pension or other retirement benefit schemes, share option schemes and company car schedules applicable to them; (g) any outstanding or potential contractual, statutory or other liabilities in respect of such individuals (including in respect of personal injury claims);

	(h) details of any such individuals on long term sickness absence, parental leave, maternity leave or other authorised long term absence; (i) copies of all relevant documents and materials relating to such information, including copies of relevant Agreements of employment (or relevant standard Agreements if applied generally in respect of such employees); and (j) any other "employee liability information" as such term is defined in regulation 11 of the Employment Regulations;
"Sub-Contract"	means an agreement entered into between the Employer and a Sub-Contractor for the purposes of engaging the Sub-Contractor to deliver part of the Services on behalf of the Employer;
"Sub-Contracting"	means any delivery to a Learner's programme of learning by a separate legal entity, irrespective of whether such learning is provided by a third party recruited to deliver on site (travel to teach), online learning or whether it is described as a service;
"Sub-Contracting Threshold"	means 25% of the Learners in each Funding Stream under this Agreement in any given Funding Year;
"Sub-Contractor"	means a separate legal entity or an individual (not an employee) that has an agreement (called a Sub-Contract) with the Employer to deliver any element of the Services the Department funds. A separate legal entity includes but is not limited to companies in the Employer's group, other associated companies and sole traders. An individual could include a person who is a sole trader, self-employed, a freelancer or someone who is employed by an agency, unless those individuals are working under the Employer's direct management and control in the same way as the Employer's own employees. This does not include relationships between the Employer and other third parties providing services such as marketing;
"Sub-Contractor Declaration"	means the declaration that the Department requires an Employer to complete specifying whether or not the Employer is Sub-Contracting any of the Services and if so, what Services and the amount of funding that represents;
"Sub-Contractor	means the Department's policies that apply to Sub-

Policies”	Contracting and Sub-Contractors as set out at: Post-16 education subcontracting: using funding to offer education and training - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk);
“Sub-Processor”	any third Party appointed to process Personal Data on behalf of that Processor related to this Agreement;
“Subsidy Control”	means the UK Government’s rules on the provision of subsidies;
“Successor Employer”	means the person nominated by the Department to undertake the services substantially the same as the Services after the termination of this Agreement;
“Termination Date”	means any date on which this Agreement terminates in accordance with Clause 35 (Termination);
“UK GDPR”	the General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679) as transposed into United Kingdom national law by operation of section 3 of the European Union (Withdrawal) Act 2018, together with the Data Protection, Privacy and Electronic Communications (Amendments etc.) (EU Exit) Regulations 2019;
“Voluntary Community and Social Enterprise” or “VCSE”	means a non-governmental organisation that is value-driven and which principally reinvests its surpluses to further social, environmental or cultural objectives;
“Working Day”	a day (other than a Saturday or Sunday) on which banks are open for domestic business in the City of London.

1.1 In this Agreement, unless the context otherwise requires, capitalised expressions shall have the meanings set out in Clause 1 above or the relevant Schedule in which that capitalised expression appears. If a capitalised expression does not have an interpretation in Clause 1 or the relevant Schedule, it shall have the meaning given to it in this Agreement.

1.2 In this Agreement except where the context otherwise requires:-

1.2.1 the masculine includes the feminine and vice-versa;

1.2.2 the singular includes the plural and vice-versa;

1.2.3 a reference to any clause, sub-clause, paragraph, schedule or annex is, except where it is expressly stated to the contrary, a reference to such clause, sub-clause, paragraph, schedule or annex of this Agreement;

1.2.4 any reference to this Agreement or to any other document shall include any permitted variation, amendment or supplement to such document;

1.2.5 any reference to any enactment, order, regulation, code, guidance or other similar instrument shall be construed as a reference to the enactment, order, regulation, code, guidance or instrument (including any EU instrument) as amended, replaced, consolidated or re-enacted;

1.2.6 references to any documents being "in the agreed form" means such documents have been initialled by or on behalf of each of the Parties for the purpose of identification;

1.2.7 a reference to a person includes firms, partnerships and corporations and their successors and permitted assignees or transferees;

1.2.8 headings are for reference only;

1.2.9 words preceding "include", "includes", "including" and "included" shall be construed without limitation by the words which follow those words;

1.2.10 the Schedules to this Agreement form part of this Agreement;

1.2.11 references to the Parties shall be to the parties to this Agreement; and

1.2.12 references to months shall mean calendar months.

1.3 No review, comment or approval by the Department under the provisions of this Agreement shall operate to exclude or limit the Employer's obligations or liabilities under this Agreement or the Department's rights under this Agreement.

1.4 Precedence of Documentation

In the event of any inconsistency between the provisions of the Terms and Conditions and the Schedules, or between any of the Schedules, the conflict shall be resolved according to the following descending order of priority:

1.4.1 the Terms and Conditions,

1.4.2 Schedule 1 (the Specification);

1.4.3 the remaining Schedules,

for the avoidance of doubt, in the event of any inconsistency between this Agreement and the Funding Rules, this Agreement will take precedence.

1.5 In relation to any provision in the Agreement, the Secretary of State may act through the Department for Education and / or its executive agency, ESFA. As such where the Agreement refers to the Department, both the

Department for Education and the ESFA are entitled to act in accordance with; and / or benefit from; and / or enforce the relevant provision.

1.6 Without prejudice to the position set out in Clause 1.5, the Department for Education will principally manage provider registers, the relationship with the Employer and any intervention. The ESFA will principally be responsible for allocations, payments, Agreement administration and assurance.

PART 2: THE SERVICES

2 COMMENCEMENT AND DURATION

2.1 The Agreement Period will commence on the Agreement Date and terminate or expire on the earlier of:

2.1.1 the Expiry Date; or

2.1.2 the Termination Date.

3 SERVICE DELIVERY

3.1 The Services to be delivered under this Agreement are those as set out in Schedule 1 (Specification). The detailed requirements in respect of the Services are also set out in the Funding Rules as amended from time to time by the Department and which form part of the terms and conditions of this Agreement.

3.2 The Services are to be delivered in accordance with the Specification, specific requirements of the Department, and all other Schedules, which all form part of the terms and conditions of the Agreement.

3.3 The Employer will comply (and will ensure that any Sub-Contractor complies) with the Department Policies.

3.4 The Employer will ensure that data relating to Learners including Learner Records is held and saved in a format that can be reasonably accessed by the Department on request.

3.5 The Department will monitor the performance of the Employer in accordance with the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework. An outline of the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework is set out in Annex 1 of the Apprenticeship Carry-in Specification & Monitoring Schedule of this Agreement.

4 EMERGENCIES AND SIGNIFICANT INCIDENTS

4.1 The Employer must have and maintain an up-to-date Business Continuity Plan. Expecting the unexpected - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)

4.2 The Employer must at the request of the Department provide whatever support and assistance may reasonably be required by the Department in

response to any national, regional or local emergency or incident including at any premises identified by the Department.

4.3 The Employer will ensure that Learners have access to portfolios, e-portfolios, learning materials and other evidence at all times.

5 PERFORMANCE MONITORING

5.1 Employer Monitoring

5.1.1 The Employer must put in place the necessary internal control framework, including an internal audit function if appropriate to ensure that it meets its obligations and those of its Sub-Contractors under this Agreement.

5.2 Department Monitoring

5.2.1 The Department will undertake its own performance monitoring, as set out in Schedule 1 (Specification) and may elect, at its own cost, to undertake further monitoring at any stage during the Agreement Period for any purpose, including ensuring that the Services are being provided in accordance with this Agreement.

5.2.2 The Employer must use its reasonable endeavours to assist the Department in any performance monitoring exercise under Clause 5.2.1. The Department may notify the Employer of the outcome of the performance monitoring exercise and the Employer must have due regard to the Department's comments in relation to the future provision of the Services.

5.2.3 Without prejudice to the Department's rights under Clauses 34 (Withholding, Suspension and Repayment of Funding) and 35.1 (Termination) and to any other express rights under this Agreement, where the Employer has been found to be fraudulent or have recklessly submitted erroneous reports, claims and/or learner data, or the Department reasonably believes such reports to be fraudulent or erroneous the Department may, by notice to the Employer, increase the level of its monitoring of the Employer, or (at the Department's option), of the Employer's monitoring of its own performance of its obligations under this Agreement in respect of the relevant Services the subject of such fraudulent, erroneous or misleading reporting until such time as the Employer must have demonstrated to the reasonable satisfaction of the Department that it will perform (and is capable of performing) its obligations under this Agreement, in which case, the following provisions will apply:

(a) any such notice to the Employer will specify in reasonable detail the additional measures to be taken by the Department or by the Employer (as the case may be) in monitoring the performance of the Employer;

(b) if the Employer (acting reasonably) objects to any of the specified measures on the grounds that they are excessive

it will notify the Department in writing within five (5) Working Days of the receipt of the notice of the measures objected to (and of any Changes necessary in order to prevent prejudice to the Employer's performance of its obligations under this Agreement);

(c) the measures to be taken by the Department and the Employer (as the case may be) will be agreed between the Parties or, in the absence of agreement within ten (10) Working Days of the Department's receipt of the Employer's objection, determined pursuant to the Dispute Resolution Procedure; and

(d) the Employer will bear its own costs and indemnify and keep the Department indemnified at all times from and against all costs and expenses reasonably and properly incurred by or on behalf of the Department in relation to such increased level of monitoring save where there is no evidence that the Employer has been found to have been fraudulent or to have submitted erroneous reports and the Employer has been exonerated.

5.3 Employer Responsible

5.3.1 The Employer acknowledges and agrees that, notwithstanding any provision of this Agreement which contemplates that the Department will or may from time to time:

(a) monitor or inspect any performance of the Services;

(b) check compliance by the Employer with its obligations; or

(c) confirm or indicate approval of or non-objection to proposals made by the Employer,

it will always be fully the responsibility of the Employer, and not the responsibility of the Department, to ensure that the Services are performed in all respects in accordance with the Employer's obligations under this Agreement and no such action by or on behalf of the Department will in any way limit or affect such obligations.

5.4 Quality Management Systems

5.4.1 The Department will have the right upon reasonable notice and at reasonable times to audit the Employer's quality management systems (for example ISO 9000 or equivalent standard) and/or any other quality management system to which the Specification refers, including examining and inspecting services and activities on or off the premises owned or occupied by the Employer to establish the adequacy or accuracy of the quality management system documentation. The Employer will use all reasonable endeavours to assist the Department in such exercise.

6 CHANGES

6.1 The Department may implement a Change to the Services during the Agreement Period.

6.2 The Department may implement a Change by communicating the change through the Department's publications, Update or Inform, or though updates to Funding Rules and other related documents on GOV.UK. The Employer will subscribe to alerts from GOV.UK so they are made aware of Changes.

7 HEALTH & SAFETY

7.1 The Employer must comply with all health and safety legislation and Health and Safety Executive working regulations, adopt and maintain safe operating systems of work and appropriate safety policies in order to protect the health and safety of Employer Personnel, Learners and all other persons including members of the public.

7.2 Where part of the Services are provided in an environment outside the direct control of the Employer, the Employer must take all reasonable steps to ensure that adequate arrangements are in place to ensure the health and safety of Learners. This will include but not be limited to, co-ordinating and co-operating with other organisations/bodies with responsibilities being clearly identified and documented as appropriate, to ensure understanding.

7.3 The Employer must report all incidents that are reportable under the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 ("RIDDOR") in accordance with those regulations and must investigate or assess the circumstances of all Learner incidents within the scope of RIDDOR and follow HSE guidance 'Investigating accidents and incidents: A workbook for employers, unions, safety representatives and safety professionals' (HSG245) ISBN 0717628272. The Employer must only use persons competent to investigate/assess Learner incidents with a view to identifying the causes of any incident and lessons to be learned.

7.4 The Employer must inform the Department of the death of any Learner during the provision of the Services. This will be done by informing the Department's representative by telephone or email immediately upon the Employer becoming aware of the death.

7.5 The Employer will, in circumstances where it Sub-Contracts the management and/or delivery of the Services under this Agreement, ensure that all the provisions in respect of health and safety in this Clause 7 are included in the Sub-Contract with each Sub-Contractor.

8 LEARNER WELFARE

8.1 In addition to its statutory health and safety responsibilities as referred to in Clause 7 (Health & Safety) above, the Employer must ensure that the Services are delivered in safe, healthy and supportive environments,

which meet the needs of Learners in accordance with this Clause 8 and Clause 24 (Employees).

8.2 Where the Employer provides residential accommodation for Learners, the Employer must inform the Department of the provision of such residential accommodation and comply with the requirements of the national minimum standards for residential accommodation for children in Colleges published from time to time by the Secretary of State under section 87C of the Children Act 1989 as if the Employer were a College (as defined by section 87(10) of the Children Act 1989).

8.3 In providing the Services, the Employer must ensure it actively promotes the fundamental British values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty, and mutual respect and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs, and promote principles that support equality of opportunity for all.

8.4 In providing the Services, the Employer must comply with the general duty on specified authorities in section 26 of the Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015 (the Prevent duty) and must have regard to statutory guidance issued under section 29 of the Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015 (Prevent duty guidance: for further education institutions in England and Wales - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)).

8.5 In providing the Services, the Employer must comply with the duty on partners of a panel in section 38 of the Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015 (the Channel co-operation duty).

8.6 The Employer will monitor, and act on, any other harm to Learners to the extent that the Employer could reasonably be expected to do so and/or where the harm could affect the quality of the learning experience. Harm includes (but is not limited to) incidents that cause absence from learning, any loss to the Learner of any physical or mental faculty or any disfigurement and incidents of bullying and harassment.

8.7 The Employer will co-operate with the Department and Department for Work and Pensions for the purposes of the Industrial Injuries Disablement Benefit (IIDB) in respect of those Learners to which it applies.

8.8 The Employer and/or the Employer Related Parties must be able to demonstrate that they have robust record-keeping procedures in respect of health, safety and safeguarding through checks on record keeping undertaken.

8.9 The Employer will ensure it notifies the Department via the Contact Form: General Enquiries at Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) where a referral has been made by the Employer or one of the Employer Related Parties in either of the following circumstances (such notification must include the name of the institution, a high level summary of the nature of the incident (without sharing personal information about victims or alleged perpetrators) and confirmation of whether it is, or is scheduled to be, investigated by the Local Authority and/or the police):

8.9.1 a safeguarding concern related to sexual violence to Local Authority children's social care/adult social care and/or the police, or

8.9.2 an allegation of abuse made against a teacher, lecturer or other member of staff to the designated officer(s) (at the local authority).

8.10 The Employer will ensure it notifies the Department via the Contact Form: General Enquires at Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) of incident(s) and/or where a referral has been made, where the Employer or one of the Employer Related Parties:

8.10.1 is aware of an incident, or pattern of incidents, which undermines the promotion of British fundamental values as referred to in Clause 8.3 or the ability of the Employer or the Employer Related Parties to comply with the Prevent duty, or

8.10.2 makes a referral of an individual member of Employer Personnel for the purposes of determining whether that member of Employer Personnel should be referred to a panel for the carrying out of an assessment under section 36 of the Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015 of the extent to which that individual is vulnerable to being drawn into terrorism.

8.11 Where it applies

8.11.1 The Employer must comply with the Modern Slavery Act 2015 and must have in place throughout the Agreement Period policies and procedures to ensure full compliance.

8.11.2 The Employer must ensure that all Sub-Contracts that it enters into include an obligation for the Sub-Contractor to comply with the Modern Slavery Act 2015 with special emphasis on express anti-slavery and anti-human trafficking provisions.

8.11.3 The Employer shall implement due diligence procedures to ensure that there is no slavery or human trafficking in any part of its supply chain.

8.12 The Employer will, in circumstances where it Sub-Contracts the management and/or delivery of the Services under this Agreement, ensure that all the provisions in respect of learner welfare in this Clause 8 are included in the Sub-Contract with each Sub-Contractor.

9 EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY

9.1 The Employer must not unlawfully discriminate within the meaning and scope of the provisions of the Equality Act 2010 or any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof or any other statutory provision relating to discrimination in employment or the provision of services. The Employer must take all reasonable steps to ensure the observance of these provisions by all servants, employees or agents of the Employer and all Sub-Contractors employed in the execution of the Agreement. The Employer will comply with the detailed requirements in relation to equality of opportunity set out in Clauses 9.2 to 9.4.

9.2 The Employer will, in delivering the Services under this Agreement, demonstrate that it has had regard to the duties placed on the Department and the Employer by the Equality Act 2010. The Employer will take all reasonable steps to ensure the observance of these provisions by all servants, employees or agents of the Employer and all Sub-Contractors engaged in the delivery of the Services.

9.3 The Employer must ensure that equality of opportunity is built into all aspects of Services; the business planning process; and the self-assessment process. The Employer must use analysis of data to inform future planning to improve the representation, participation and success of underrepresented and underachieving groups and challenge stereotyping. The Employer must use appropriate, specific and measurable objectives. These will be proportionate, relevant and aligned to the Services the Employer is funded to deliver.

9.4 The Department may use a variety of equality information and data to support judgements about quality and eligibility for funding. These may include, but are not limited to: inspection judgements for equality and diversity, judgements from the Equality and Human Rights Commission, and the success and participation rates of different groups of Learners.

10 QUALITY ASSURANCE AND RAISING STANDARDS

10.1 The Employer undertakes to the Department that it and any Employer Related Party has the resources and skills necessary to carry out the Employer's obligations pursuant to this Agreement.

10.2 The Employer must comply with the Funding Rules published by the Department as amended from time to time and any other requirements, which may from time to time be issued by the Department, Inspectorates, the Awarding Organisations and other Regulatory Bodies and of which the Employer is made aware.

10.3 The Employer must ensure that all activities carried out pursuant to this Agreement will be documented in accordance with any requirements of the Department and must provide such documentation as the Department may request from time to time to ensure compliance with this Clause 10.3.

10.4 The Employer will continuously seek to improve the Services and raise standards to benefit the Learner. The Employer will have the primary responsibility for improving standards and will need to demonstrate to the Department's satisfaction that it has an effective quality assurance system based on the implementation of its own quality improvement process. The Department reserves the right to require the Employer to provide the Department or Ofsted evidence to support the quality improvement processes.

10.5 The Employer must use all reasonable endeavours to:

(a) minimise dropout rates and deliver high completion and achievement rates and appropriate progression;

(b) offer equality of access to learning opportunities and close equality gaps in learning and outcomes;

(c) provide good management and leadership of the learning process;

(d) deliver value for money and financial probity; and

(e) ensure all Sub-Contractors delivering Services under the Agreement on behalf of the Employer comply with the requirements set out in Clauses 10.5(a) to 10.5(d) above.

10.6 Failure to meet the requirements set out in Clauses 10.5(a) to 10.5(e) may result in the Department assessing the Employer to be in breach of the Agreement.

10.7 The Employer must take all reasonable steps to meet the relevant requirements for data gathering for the FE Choices Performance Indicators as outlined currently at Learner and employer satisfaction data: information for providers - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) and in any subsequent updates to these web pages.

10.8 Where appropriate, the Employer must confirm in writing to the Department that their (including Employer Related Parties) Centre Approval Status for the relevant Services is still current. The written statement will need to confirm approved centre status for the specific Regulated Qualification Framework ("RQF") titles and levels, including Awarding Organisation name(s).

10.9 The Employer must notify the Department immediately in writing via the Contact Form: General Enquires at Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) if it receives any sanction from an Awarding Organisation , including but not limited to the suspension and/or removal of Centre Approval Status and/or the removal of the ability to register or certificate learners.

10.10 The Department can request any Awarding Organisation reports, assessments and notices from the Employer at any time.

10.11 The Department may assess the quality and delivery of the Services and the Employer's compliance with the requirements in Clauses 10.5(a) to 10.5(e) during the Agreement Period. The Employer will be informed of the outcome of that process. Where the Department assesses the Employer to be in breach of agreement following such assessment the Department will issue a notice which, where the Department is not terminating, may:

(a) require the Employer to meet improvement indicators to improve the quality of its Services. The Department will meet with the Employer to discuss and reach agreement on implementation of these actions and improvement indicators and to agree arrangements for monitoring and reviewing progress. In such cases reviews will take place at the frequency specified by the Department and in agreement with the Employer;

(b) agree detailed improvement plans and measures that set out clearly the expected timescale for improvement;

(c) agree arrangements for more frequent monitoring of quality improvement plans.

11 FINANCIAL HEALTH

11.1 The Employer will immediately notify the Department in writing if:

11.1.1 the Employer commences negotiations with all or any class of its creditors with a view to rescheduling any of its debts, or makes a proposal for or enters into any compromise or arrangement with any of its creditors other than for the sole purpose of a scheme for a solvent amalgamation of the Employer with one or more other companies or the solvent reconstruction of the Employer;

11.1.2 a petition is filed, a notice is given, a resolution is passed, or an order is made, for or in connection with the winding up of the Employer other than for the sole purpose of a scheme for a solvent amalgamation of the Employer with one or more other companies or the solvent reconstruction of the Employer;

11.1.3 the Employer suspends or ceases, or threatens to suspend or cease, carrying on all or a substantial part of its business; or

11.1.4 there is a change of control of the Employer (within the meaning of section 1124 of the Corporation Tax Act 2010).

11.2 The Department reserves the right, at any reasonable time, and as it may deem necessary to require the Employer, at its own cost, to:

11.2.1 provide evidence of financial resources and the level of turnover sufficient to enable it to continue to deliver the Services; and

11.2.2 provide a copy of the Employer's latest audited Accounts.

12 INSPECTIONS

12.1 When the Employer receives notification from an Inspectorate that the Services are to be inspected, the Employer will, on request, provide the Department with details of its quality improvement activity, and any other relevant information in accordance with the required timescale of the Inspectorate. The Employer must notify the Department via the Contact Form: General Enquires at Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) of the date of the meeting at which an Inspectorate gives feedback on the inspection and allow the Department's nominated representative to attend the meeting. The Employer must confirm to the Department in writing the outcome of the inspection within 5 Working Days of receiving the feedback from the Inspectorate.

12.2 Ofsted may, at any time during the Agreement Period, undertake an inspection of the Employer. The Department will consider the outcome of any such inspection in the manner set out in Clauses 12.3 to 12.7.

Inadequate in part

12.3 Where Ofsted has assessed the Services to be inadequate in any graded sub-judgement, the Department may, in its absolute discretion take one or more of the following actions:

12.3.1 require the Employer to accept and comply with additional conditions of funding relating to the improvement of the Services assessed as inadequate; and/or

12.3.2 require the Employer to suspend the recruitment of Learners to, and/or to cap any growth in, the Services which is assessed as inadequate; and/or

12.3.3 give consideration to the Services which are assessed as inadequate in its allocations when finalising the amount of Funding in any subsequent Agreements between the Parties; and/or

12.3.4 reduce, suspend or recover payment to the Employer in respect of that part of the Services assessed as inadequate; and/or

12.3.5 terminate the Agreement in accordance with Clause 35.3.4.

Inadequate overall

12.4 Where the Department is made aware that Ofsted has provisionally assessed the Services to be inadequate overall, the Department may, in its absolute discretion commence discussions with the Employer and other relevant co-funding regulatory bodies where appropriate as part of considering what actions as specified in Clauses 12.5.1 to 12.5.5 inclusive may be taken.

12.5 Where Ofsted has published its assessment that the Services are inadequate overall, the Department may, in its absolute discretion take one or more of the following actions:

12.5.1 require the Employer to accept and comply with additional conditions of funding relating to the improvement of the overall Services; and/or

12.5.2 require the Employer to suspend the recruitment of Learners to, and/or to cap any growth in, those Learning Programmes which are assessed as inadequate; and/or

12.5.3 give consideration to the Services which are assessed as inadequate in its allocations when finalising the amount of Funding in any subsequent Agreements between the Parties; and/or

12.5.4 reduce, suspend or recover payment to the Employer; and/or

12.5.5 terminate this Agreement in accordance with Clause 35.3.4 (Termination).

12.6 The failure of the Employer, as assessed by the Department, to comply with any requirements of Clauses 12.5.1 to 12.5.2 inclusive within such time as the Department may deem reasonable may lead to the Department taking such actions as it deems appropriate which may

include, but is not limited to, terminating the Agreement in accordance with Clause 35.3.3 (Termination).

12.7 The Department will take action based on the Inspectorate's published outcomes as in Clause 12.5 above. Where the Department is made aware that the Employer has made a complaint about the graded outcome of the overall assessment by Ofsted, the Department will continue to progress action under Clauses 12.4 to 12.5 but will be mindful of the implications arising from the outcome of a complaint. The Department will review any decisions made at such time as outcomes of any complaint are made known.

12.8 If an Inspectorate rating is given based on incorrect or fraudulent information or data from the Employer this will constitute a breach of agreement and the Department may, at its sole discretion, terminate the Agreement.

Ofsted Monitoring Visit

12.9 Where Ofsted has published its assessment that the Employer is making "insufficient progress" on any of the Monitoring Visit inspection themes, the Department may, in its absolute discretion take the following actions:

12.9.1 require the Employer to, and the Employer shall, accept and comply with additional conditions of funding relating to the improvement of the overall Provision within agreed timescales. Such conditions will include complying with the published recommendations of Ofsted. These conditions will apply until a full Ofsted inspection or further Ofsted Monitoring Visit of the Employer has taken place; and/or

12.9.2 require the Employer to temporarily suspend the recruitment of Learners; and/or

12.9.3 require the Employer to temporarily suspend the recruitment of Learners via a Sub-Contracting arrangement with another main provider or employer-provider; and/or

12.9.4 require the Employer to inform all of their existing main providers or employer-providers about the outcome of the Ofsted visit; and/or

12.9.5 terminate this Agreement in accordance with Clause 35.3.5 (Termination) where Learners may be at immediate risk on the grounds of safeguarding issues and/or the quality of leadership and/or training provision is such that one or more Learner has no reasonable prospect of achieving their training objective; and/or

12.9.6 terminate this Agreement in accordance with Clause 35.3.6 (Termination) if the Employer has two (2) consecutive Ofsted Monitoring Visits each resulting in one or more "insufficient progress" judgements in relation to one or more themes; and/or

12.9.7 remove the Employer from the Register of Apprenticeship Training Providers if the Employer has two (2) consecutive Ofsted

Monitoring Visits each resulting in one or more “insufficient progress” judgements in relation to one or more themes.

12.10 In addition to the actions in Clauses 12.9.1 to 12.9.4, where the Provision relates to Apprenticeship Provision, the Department may, in its absolute discretion take the following actions:

12.10.1 require the Employer to inform all of their existing employers about the outcome of the Ofsted visit;

12.10.2 Where the Department is made aware that Ofsted has assessed a Sub-Contractor to the Employer as having made “insufficient progress” during their programme of Ofsted Monitoring Visits, the Employer is required to ensure that the Sub-Contractor suspends the recruitment of Learners until further notice.

13 NOT USED

14 FRAUD AND IRREGULARITY

14.1 The Employer must notify the Department immediately where it becomes aware of any instance of suspected fraud or financial irregularity in the delivery of the Agreement including, but not limited to, cases of:

14.1.1 collusion with members of the staff of the Department or employees of the Department for Education;

14.1.2 computer fraud;

14.1.3 the submission to the Department of inaccurate, incomplete, misleading or falsified information for the purpose of a claim for funding;

14.1.4 fraud involving Awarding Organisations;

14.1.5 fraud involving Sub-Contractors;

provided that nothing in this Clause 14 will require the Employer to do anything, which may cause it to infringe any Law.

14.2 Where the Department has reasonable cause to suspect that fraud or irregularity has occurred in relation to the delivery of the Agreement and payments made hereunder, the Department and/or its agents will have:

14.2.1 the right of access to the Employer’s Premises (or that of any of its Sub-Contractors) at any reasonable time with or without notice to examine and remove or copy all relevant documents and records including electronic records;

14.2.2 the right to require the Employer to provide written authority to enable the Department to obtain such documents, records and/or information directly from third parties; and

14.2.3 the right to interview the Employer’s servants or agents engaged with the delivery of the Agreement.

Failure to comply with this Clause 14.2 will constitute a breach of agreement.

14.3 Where the Department has reasonable cause to suspect that fraud or irregularity has occurred in relation to the delivery of the Agreement and payments made hereunder, the Department may require the Employer to procure the services of an independent accountant (or other equivalent/appropriate professional) to investigate at the Employer's cost (or the Department will procure and recharge to the Employer at its sole discretion).

14.4 Where the Department has reasonable cause to suspect that fraud or irregularity has occurred in relation to the delivery of the Agreement or any other Agreement between the Department and the Employer and payments made thereunder, the Department will have the right to suspend payments and/or require the Employer to suspend recruitment of Learners under this Agreement and any other Agreement between the Parties.

14.5 Where the Employer is a registered or exempt charity, the Employer will inform the Department of any schemes, orders or official warnings issued to them by the Charity Commission. Failure to inform the Department will constitute a breach of agreement.

14.6 The Parties will co-operate in the identification of Learners who may be unlawfully claiming benefits. The Department may from time to time brief the Employer as to the co-operation and assistance it reasonably requires including the provision of information regarding fraud by Learners. The Department will provide a named contact or telephone answering machine for receiving such information.

PART 3: AGREEMENT GOVERNANCE

15 RELATIONSHIPS

15.1 Information and Assistance

15.1.1 Subject to any obligation in respect of confidentiality, the Data Protection Legislation and Confidential Information, the Parties will use all reasonable endeavours to provide and share information and data reasonably required by the other:

(a) to enable it to perform its obligations under this Agreement; and/or

(b) (in the case of the Employer) which is reasonably necessary to enable the Department to perform its statutory obligations and other functions insofar as such provision forms part of the Services.

15.1.2 Neither Party will hinder, delay or prevent the other Party in the performance of the other Party's obligations under this Agreement.

15.2 Enquiries, Investigations and Inspections

15.2.1 The Employer must and will ensure that its Sub-Contractors will at all times during the Agreement Period and for a period of six (6) years, or such other time period as stated in the Specification

(Schedule 1), afterwards fully co-operate with any enquiry, investigation or inspection (whether routine or specific) which in any way concerns, affects or relates to the Services, or any sum claimed or charged in relation to this Agreement or to any other Agreement of the Department. Such enquiry, investigation or inspection may be by, inter alia:-

(a) the Department;

(b) the Department's auditors (whether internal or external);

(c) Regulatory Bodies; and/or

(d) the Inspectorates.

15.2.2 Such co-operation will include (but not be limited to) the following:-

(a) providing access to or copies of such files, documents, letters, emails, notes, minutes, records, accounts or any other information (whether held or stored electronically, in hard copy format or otherwise) which relate to the subject or Service (in whole or in part) under investigation;

(b) providing access to the premises, equipment (including IT hardware and software) or other assets used by the Employer and/or its Sub-Contractors in the performance of this Agreement, such access to be supervised at all times unless the nature of the investigation requires the parties defined at Clause 15.2.1 to be unsupervised, such parties acting reasonably in making such assessment;

(c) providing access to Employer Personnel (of whatever seniority) involved in this Agreement (including managerial or supervisory staff) or who may be the subject of, or be named in, any enquiry or investigation by the auditors or the ombudsmen (including providing suitable facilities for interviewing such staff);

(d) maintaining the confidentiality of the enquiry or investigation when requested to do so;

(e) making such explanations (whether written or oral) as may be necessary for the enquiry or investigation to be satisfied that the terms and conditions of this Agreement, the Funding Rules and the Law are being complied with;

(f) at all times and without notice allowing access to the Inspectorates, in connection with any complaint, investigation or inspection relating to this Agreement or the Services. This will extend to the Employer's Premises; and to all documentation and information relating to this Agreement to which the Employer has access; and to the Employer's agents, employees and Sub-Contractors.

15.2.3 Where the Department has undertaken an investigation or received a report from an independent accountant or otherwise, in relation to the Employer it may, as a consequence of that

investigation or report, require the Employer to, and the Employer will, accept and comply with additional conditions of funding and will meet the cost of such investigation.

15.2.4 Where the Employer fails to comply with the additional conditions imposed under Clause 15.2.3, within such time as the Department deems reasonable, the Department may take such actions as it deems appropriate which may include, but is not limited to terminating the Agreement in accordance with Clause 35 (Termination).

15.2.5 The Employer will in performing the Services comply fully with all relevant rules and regulations of the Department in force from time to time.

15.2.6 The Employer will, if requested by the Department, co-operate with the Department, at its own expense, in connection with any legal proceedings, adjudication, arbitration, court proceedings or ombudsmen enquiries in which the Department may become involved, arising from breaches of the Department's duties under the Equalities Legislation due to the alleged acts or omissions of the Employer, its employees, Sub-Contractors or agents.

15.2.7 The Employer will ensure that the terms of any Sub-Contract include identical provisions to this Clause 15 (Relationships) and will indemnify the Department against any losses, damages or claims it suffers in consequence of a failure to ensure the inclusion of such identical items.

15.3 Complaints and Feedback

15.3.1 The primary responsibility for receiving feedback and investigating complaints promptly and thoroughly in respect of the Services will rest with the Employer. The Employer will have procedures in place including but not limited to a complaints framework, which are acceptable to the Department, to gather and act upon feedback and complaints from Learners and/or their representatives and employers and the wider community. The Employer must also keep a log of the complaints received which will be accessible to the Department upon request.

15.3.2 The Employer must ensure that Learners are made aware of its procedure for dealing with complaints and that the procedure is clear and accessible to Learners who wish to complain. The complaints procedure must be published on the Employer's website and be provided to the relevant parties as part of the Employer's onboarding process.

15.3.3 The Employer will be responsible for resolving complaints in accordance with its own procedures and any guidance issued by the Department. Once the Employer has concluded its investigations, including any appeal, it must inform the complainant in writing of the outcome.

15.3.4 Where a complaint has not been resolved to the satisfaction of the complainant the Employer will advise the complainant of their right to complain to the Department (Complaints procedure - Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)) and co-operate with any investigation carried out by the Department and act on any recommendations made by the Department following the investigation.

16 REPRESENTATIVE

16.1 Agreement Manager

16.1.1 Without limiting the Department's obligations or rights in respect of such matters the Department will appoint an Agreement Manager who may subject to Clause 16.1.2 exercise the rights and powers conferred by this Agreement upon the Department.

16.1.2 Except pursuant to Clause 44 (Amendments to this Agreement), or unless specifically authorised for that purpose, the Agreement Manager does not have authority to amend the Agreement or to relieve the Employer of any express obligations under the Agreement.

16.2 Account Manager

16.2.1 The Employer will notify the Department in writing of the name, telephone number, e-mail address and the postal address of the person appointed as the Account Manager.

16.2.2 The Account Manager may exercise the functions, rights and powers conferred by this Agreement upon the Employer.

16.2.3 In the event that the Employer wishes to change the identity of the Account Manager, it will, subject to Clause 16.2.4 give to the Department not less than 5 Working Days' notice in writing of such change. Such written notice will inform the Department of the name, telephone number e-mail address and postal address of the new Account Manager.

16.2.4 In the event that it is not possible or practical for any reason for the Employer to give notice to the Department in accordance with Clause 16.2.3 the Employer will notify the Department by whatever means the Employer considers appropriate and will confirm such notification in writing within 5 Working Days.

16.3 User Role Management System

16.3.1 The Employer must ensure that those senior members of staff who are authorised to agree and sign Agreements on behalf of the Employer, submit Funding claims and return data are registered as users of the user role management system at Skills Funding Agency: Login (fasst.org.uk). It is the Employer's responsibility to maintain appropriate user roles on an on-going basis.

17 DISPUTE RESOLUTION

17.1 Any dispute will be dealt with in accordance with this Clause 17.

17.2 In the first instance, a representative of each Party will each use their reasonable endeavours to resolve the dispute. If the dispute cannot be resolved by such representatives within 15 days of the dispute arising, it will be referred to a senior representative of each Party, who will each use their reasonable endeavours to resolve the dispute.

17.3 If a dispute cannot be resolved by negotiation as referred to in Clause 17.2 within 30 days of the dispute arising, either Party may refer the dispute for determination in accordance with the mediation procedure administered by the Centre for Effective Dispute Resolution, the costs of the mediator being split equally between the Parties, who will otherwise bear their own costs.

PART 4: IPR DATA AND CONFIDENTIALITY

18 ASSIGNMENT OF IPR IN DATABASES

18.1 The Employer hereby assigns to the Department, with full title guarantee, title to and all rights and interest in the information contained in or stored on the Database or will procure that the first owner of the Database assigns it to the Department on the same basis.

18.2 The assignment under Clause 18.1 will either take effect on the Agreement Date or as a present assignment of future rights that will take effect immediately on the coming into existence of the Database, as appropriate.

18.3 The Employer will waive or procure a waiver of any moral rights in the Database assigned to the Department under this Agreement.

18.4 To the extent that it is necessary for the Department to obtain the full benefits of ownership of the Database, the Employer hereby grants to the Department and will procure that any relevant third party licensor will grant to the Department an irrevocable, non-exclusive and global licence to use the Database.

19 DEPARTMENT DATA

19.1 The Employer acknowledges that the Department Data is the property of the Department and the Department hereby reserve all Intellectual Property Rights which may subsist in the Department Data.

19.2 The Employer must perform secure back-ups of all the Department Data and must ensure that up-to-date back-ups, where not in the cloud, are stored off-site in accordance with the Business Continuity Plan. Back-ups stored in the cloud must comply with Data Protection Legislation. The Employer must ensure that such back-ups are available to the Department at all times upon request.

19.3 The Employer must take all necessary steps to ensure that any Department Data which comes into its possession or control is protected in accordance with the Data Protection Legislation and appropriate security procedures as set out in Schedule 7 (Security & Department Policies) and in compliance with Good Industry Practice (having regard to the nature of its other obligations under this Agreement and under the Data Protection Legislation).

19.4 In the event that the Department Data used in the provision of the Services is corrupted or lost by the Employer as a result of a breach by the Employer of Clause 22 (Security), the Department will have the option, in addition to any other remedies that may be available to them either under this Agreement or otherwise, to elect either of the following remedies:-

19.4.1 the Department may require the Employer at its own expense to restore or procure the restoration of such the Department Data using the back-up copy referred to in Clause 19.2; or

19.4.2 the Department may itself restore or procure restoration of such the Department Data using the back-up copy referred to in Clause 19.2 and will be repaid by the Employer any reasonable expenses so incurred.

19.5 In the event that the Department Data used in the provision of the Services is corrupted or lost solely as a result of an act or omission by the Department the Department will, at its own expense,

19.5.1 require the Employer to restore or procure the restoration of the Department Data using the back-up copy referred to in Clause 19.2; or

19.5.2 the Department may itself restore or procure the restoration of the Department Data.

19.6 The Employer must:-

19.6.1 not use the Department Data, except as may be required to provide the Services or as instructed by the Department;

19.6.2 not disclose the Department Data to any third party, other than in accordance with the requirements of the Data Protection Legislation for the purposes of fulfilling its obligations under this Agreement, except with the prior written consent of the Department or as required by this Agreement;

19.6.3 undertake its obligations under this Agreement in such a manner as to preserve so far as reasonably possible the integrity and prevent any loss, disclosure, theft, manipulation or interception of the Department Data; and/or

19.6.4 upon request provide the Department with full access to the relevant area of any systems of the Employer or its Sub-Contractors where the Department Data is stored or held for the purpose of viewing, retrieving, copying or otherwise dealing with the Department Data.

20 DATA PROTECTION AND PROTECTION OF PERSONAL DATA

20.1 The Parties acknowledge that for the purposes of the Data Protection Legislation, the Department on behalf of the Secretary of State for Education is the Data Controller and the Employer is the Data Processor only for the processing set out in Schedule 6 (i.e. submission of Learner data to the Department). Any other processing of Personal Data undertaken by the Employer (i.e. Learner enrolment or delivering education & training, e.g. e-portfolios) will be as a Data Controller and not on behalf of the Department. Clauses 20.2 to 20.14 below apply only in relation to the processing of Personal Data on behalf of the Department as set out in Schedule 6, and the only processing that the Data Processor is authorised to do on behalf of the Department is listed in Schedule 6 by the Department and may not be determined by the Data Processor.

20.2 The Data Processor must notify the Data Controller immediately if it considers that any of the Data Controller's instructions infringe the Data Protection Legislation.

20.3 The Data Processor must provide all reasonable assistance to the Data Controller in the preparation of any Data Protection Impact Assessment prior to commencing any processing. Such assistance may, at the discretion of the Data Controller, include:

(a) a systematic description of the envisaged processing operations and the purpose of the processing;

(b) an assessment of the necessity and proportionality of the processing operations in relation to the Services;

(c) an assessment of the risks to the rights and freedoms of Data Subjects; and

(d) the measures envisaged to address the risks, including safeguards, security measures and mechanisms to ensure the protection of Personal Data.

20.4 If requested by the Department's Agreement Manager, the Data Processor must, in relation to any Personal Data processed in connection with its obligations under this Agreement:

20.4.1 process that Personal Data only in accordance with Schedule 6, unless the Data Processor is required to do otherwise by Law. If it is so required the Data Processor will promptly notify the Data Controller before processing the Personal Data unless prohibited by Law;

20.4.2 ensure that it has in place Protective Measures, which are appropriate to protect against a Data Loss Event, which the Data Controller may reasonably reject (but failure to reject will not amount to approval by the Data Controller of the adequacy of the Protective Measures), having taken account of the:

(a) nature of the data to be protected;

(b) harm that might result from a Data Loss Event;

(c) state of technological development; and

(d) cost of implementing any measures;

20.4.3 ensure that:

(a) the Data Processor Personnel do not process Personal Data except in accordance with this Agreement (and in particular Schedule 6);

(b) it takes all reasonable steps to ensure the reliability and integrity of any Data Processor Personnel who have access to the Personal Data and ensure that they:

(i) are aware of and comply with the Data Processor's duties under this clause;

(ii) are subject to appropriate confidentiality undertakings with the Data Processor or any Data Sub-Processor;

(iii) are informed of the confidential nature of the Personal Data and do not publish, disclose or divulge any of the Personal Data to any third Party unless directed in writing to do so by the Data Controller or as otherwise permitted by this Agreement; and

(iv) have undergone adequate training in the use, care, protection and handling of Personal Data; and

20.4.4 not make a Restricted Transfer unless the prior written consent of the Data Controller has been obtained and the following conditions are fulfilled:

(a) the Data Controller or the Data Processor has provided appropriate safeguards in relation to the transfer (whether in accordance with Data Protection Legislation) as determined by the Data Controller;

(b) the Data Subject has enforceable rights and effective legal remedies;

(c) the Data Processor complies with its obligations under the Data Protection Legislation by providing an adequate level of protection to any Personal Data that is transferred (or, if it is not so bound, uses its best endeavours to assist the Data Controller in meeting its obligations); and

(d) the Data Processor complies with any reasonable instructions notified to it in advance by the Data Controller with respect to the processing of the Personal Data;

20.4.5 at the written direction of the Data Controller, delete or return Personal Data (and any copies of it) to the Data Controller on termination of the Agreement unless the Data Processor is required by Law to retain the Personal Data.

20.5 Subject to Clause 20.6, the Data Processor must notify the Data Controller immediately if it:

20.5.1 receives a Data Subject Access Request (or purported Data Subject Access Request) in relation to processing their data under this Agreement only (submission of learner data);

20.5.2 receives a request to rectify, block or erase any Personal Data processed through the submission of learner data. Notification in such cases should be given via the Agreement Manager;

20.5.3 receives any other request, complaint or communication relating to either Party's obligations under the Data Protection Legislation;

20.5.4 receives any communication from the Information Commissioner or any other Regulatory Body in connection with Personal Data processed under this Agreement;

20.5.5 receives a request from any third Party for disclosure of Personal Data where compliance with such request is required or purported to be required by Law; or

20.5.6 becomes aware of a Data Loss Event.

20.6 The Data Processor's obligation to notify under Clause 20.5 will include the provision of further information to the Data Controller in phases, as details become available.

20.7 Taking into account the nature of the processing, the Data Processor will provide the Data Controller with full assistance in relation to either Party's obligations under Data Protection Legislation and any complaint, communication or request made under Clause 20.5 (and insofar as possible within the timescales reasonably required by the Data Controller) including by promptly providing:

20.7.1 the Data Controller with full details and copies of the complaint, communication or request;

20.7.2 such assistance as is reasonably requested by the Data Controller to enable the Data Controller to comply with a Data Subject Access Request within the relevant timescales set out in the Data Protection Legislation;

20.7.3 the Data Controller, at its request, with any Personal Data it holds in relation to a Data Subject;

20.7.4 assistance as requested by the Data Controller following any Data Loss Event;

20.7.5 assistance as requested by the Data Controller with respect to any request from the Information Commissioner's Office, or any consultation by the Data Controller with the Information Commissioner's Office.

20.8 The Data Processor must maintain complete and accurate records and information to demonstrate its compliance with this clause. This requirement does not apply where the Data Processor employs fewer than 250 staff, unless:

20.8.1 the Data Controller determines that the processing is not occasional;

20.8.2 the Data Controller determines the processing includes special categories of data as referred to in the Data Protection Legislation or Personal Data relating to criminal convictions and offences referred to in the Data Protection Legislation; or

20.8.3 the Data Controller determines that the processing is likely to result in a risk to the rights and freedoms of Data Subjects.

20.9 The Data Processor will allow for audits of its Data Processing activity by the Data Controller or the Data Controller's designated auditor.

20.10 Each Party will designate its own data protection officer if required by the Data Protection Legislation.

20.11 Before allowing any Data Sub-Processor to process any Personal Data related to this Agreement (submission of learner data), the Data Processor must:

20.11.1 notify the Data Controller's Agreement Manager in writing of the intended Data Sub-Processor and processing;

20.11.2 obtain the written consent of the Data Controller's Agreement Manager;

20.11.3 enter into a written agreement with the Data Sub-Processor which give effect to the terms set out in this Clause 20 such that they apply to the Data Sub-Processor; and

20.11.4 provide the Data Controller with such information regarding the Data Sub-Processor as the Data Controller may reasonably require.

20.12 The Data Processor will remain fully liable for all acts or omissions of any of its Data Sub-Processors.

20.13 The Data Controller may, at any time on not less than 30 Working Days' notice, revise this clause by replacing it with any applicable Data Controller to Data Processor standard clauses or similar terms forming part of an applicable certification scheme (which will apply when incorporated by attachment to this Agreement).

20.14 The Parties agree to take account of any guidance issued by the Information Commissioner's Office. The Data Controller may on not less than 30 Working Days' notice to the Data Processor amend this Agreement to ensure that it complies with any guidance issued by the Information Commissioner's Office.

20.15 Where the Employer is providing the Services to Learners claiming out of work benefits, the Secretary of State for Work and Pensions (or their successor) is the Data Controller in relation to Personal Data which the Employer is required to provide to the Secretary of State for Work and Pensions. This Clause 20 will be enforceable by the Secretary of State for Work and Pensions in relation to any Personal Data processed by the Employer on its behalf.

20.16 Where the Employer is providing the Service to Learners who are subject to active management by the Offender Manager in respect of an order or licence, the Secretary of State for Justice (or their successor) is the Data Controller in relation to Personal Data, which the Employer is required to provide to the Secretary of State for Education.

20.17 Where the Employer is providing the Services to Learners who are subject to claiming Industrial Injuries Disablement Benefit (IIDB), the Department for Work and Pensions (or their successor) is the Data Controller in relation to Personal Data, which the Employer is required to provide to the Secretary of State for Education. This Clause 20 will be enforceable by the Secretary of State for Work and Pensions in relation to any Personal Data processed by the Employer on its behalf.

20.18 The Data Processor will comply with any further written instructions or additional conditions from the Department's Data Controller in relation to the data processing.

20.19 In the circumstances set out in Clause 36.1.7, the Department may elect to take the role of Data Controller.

21 SUBMISSION OF LEARNER DATA

21.1 General

21.1.1 The Employer must supply the Department with data in accordance with the following:

(a) in line with agreed audit arrangements;

(b) in adherence with the Data Protection Legislation;

(c) to support payments to be made;

(d) to enable reconciliation to take place;

(e) to support the Agreement management and allocation processes; and

(f) any written request from the Department.

21.1.2 The Employer undertakes to the Department to submit accurate data.

21.1.3 Where the Department is concerned about the quality of the data, including the completeness or accuracy of the data, provided by the Employer, the Department may require the Employer to supply data more frequently for such a period as the Department will require and the Department may audit, or instruct a third party to audit, at the Employer's cost, the Employer's data and controls to gain assurance that the quality improvements have been made.

21.1.4 The Department reserves the right to require the Employer, at its own cost, to carry out such work as the Department deems necessary to improve the quality of data.

21.1.5 The Department reserves the right to suspend payments to the Employer under the Agreement where data quality gives rise to

concern about the accuracy of the data provided by the Employer and take any action under the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework.

21.1.6 Where the Employer is providing the Services to Learners claiming out of work benefits, it must provide data to the Secretary of State with responsibility for unemployment or their nominated representative in accordance with the requirements notified to the Employer. Failure to transmit complete and accurate data under this Clause 21 will constitute a breach of agreement and may result in payments for this part of the Services being suspended and / or withdrawn in accordance with Clause 34 (Withholding, Suspension and Repayment of Funding) and / or termination under Clause 35 (Termination).

21.1.7 The Employer must update the course information with details of all of the Services funded by the Department to the course directory (Publish to the course directory (nationalcareers.service.gov.uk)). The Employer must regularly review this information and keep it updated.

21.1.8 The Employer must register with UKRLP (UK Register of Learning Providers (ukrlp.co.uk)) and Get Information About Schools (Get information about schools - GOV.UK (get-information-schools.service.gov.uk)) and maintain contact details on an on-going basis.

21.1.9 The Employer must publish online the set of information as set out at What academies, free schools and colleges must or should publish online - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk).

21.1.10 The Employer must submit data about any member of its workforce in the format and to the timescales as required by the Department.

21.1.11 Failure to transmit complete and accurate data to the Department in accordance with this Clause 21 will constitute a breach of agreement.

21.2 FE Data Submission

21.2.1 Where required, the Employer must supply the Department data on each individual Learner, in accordance with the data collections framework set out in the 'ILR specification validation rules and appendices' as amended and updated, which is published on the Department's website Individualised Learner Record (ILR) technical documents, guidance and requirements (submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk) and in accordance with the '*Provider Support Manual*' as amended and updated.

21.2.2 The Employer must report new starts within 2 months of the Learner starting, or within 3 months of the Learner finishing for all withdrawals and achievements. The Employer must report all changes by the final collection of the Funding Year.

21.2.3 ILR data, supplementary data and Earnings Adjustment Statements must be transmitted to the Department through the Department's web portal Submit learner data (submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk). Access to the Department's web portal is restricted and the Employer agrees to comply with the conditions of use regarding the supply of data to the Department set out in this Clause 21.2.3 and in the 'Individualised Learner Record Specification' and relevant Employer Support Manual as amended and updated available on the Department's web site.

21.2.4 The Department will confirm the data successfully submitted through Funding Reports Individualised Learner Record (ILR) - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) posted on the Department's web portal after the data has been submitted. The Employer must correct or remove data that fails the validation rules as set out in the ILR specification Individualised Learner Record (ILR) technical documents, guidance and requirements (submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk).

21.2.5 Where required, the Employer must submit supplementary data for delivery that cannot be recorded through the ILR, or to correct data you have recorded in the ILR, following the published guidance ESFA: European Social Fund (ESF) round 2 supplementary data collection - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) ("Supplementary Data"). The Employer must check the accuracy of the submissions on the Supplementary Data on the Submit Learner Data service and any errors must be corrected immediately. All submissions must be supported by evidence.

21.2.6 Where required, the Employer must use the Earnings Adjustment Statement ("EAS") to claim funding that cannot be recorded through the ILR. The funding must be submitted as detailed in the guidance Individualised Learner Record (ILR) technical documents, guidance and requirements (submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk). The Employer must check the accuracy of the submissions on the EAS via the Submit Learner Data service and any errors must be corrected immediately. All submissions must be supported by evidence.

22 SECURITY

22.1 The Employer must comply, and will ensure compliance by the Employer Personnel, with the provisions of Schedule 7 (Security & Department Policies).

23 FREEDOM OF INFORMATION AND CONFIDENTIALITY

23.1 Freedom of Information

23.1.1 The Employer acknowledges that the Department is subject to legal duties under FOIA, which may require the Department to

disclose on request information relating to this Agreement or otherwise relating to the Employer.

23.1.2 The Employer acknowledges and agrees that the Department is required by Law to consider each and every request made under FOIA for information.

23.1.3 The Employer acknowledges and agrees that all decisions made by the Department pursuant to a request under FOIA are solely a matter for and are at the discretion of the Department.

23.1.4 Notwithstanding anything in this Agreement to the contrary (including without limitation any obligations of confidentiality), the Department will be entitled to disclose information in whatever form pursuant to a request made under FOIA, save that in relation to any information that is Exempt Information the Department will use reasonable endeavours (but will not be obliged) to consult the Employer and will not:

(a) confirm or deny that information is held by the Department; or

(b) disclose information requested

to the extent that in the Department's opinion the information is eligible in the circumstances for an exemption and therefore the Department may lawfully refrain from doing either of the things described in parts (a) and (b) of this clause.

23.1.5 In relation to information relating to the Employer or the Agreement which the Employer requests should be exempt under the FOIA. The Employer will indemnify the Department for any and all costs (including legal fees) incurred by the Department in:

(a) assessing the application of any exemption under FOIA; and/or

(b) responding to any FOIA notice; and/or

(c) lodging any appeal against a decision of the Information Commissioner in relation to disclosure

where such costs are incurred pursuant to efforts by the Department to withhold Exempt Information.

23.1.6 The Department will on no account be liable for any loss, damage, harm or detriment, howsoever caused, arising from or in connection with the disclosure under FOIA of any Exempt Information or other information whether relating to this Agreement or otherwise relating to the Employer.

23.1.7 The Employer will assist the Department as reasonably necessary to enable the Department to comply with its obligations under FOIA.

23.2 Confidentiality

23.2.1 The Employer hereby warrants that:

(a) any person employed or engaged by it (in connection with this Agreement in the course of such employment or engagement) will treat all Confidential Information belonging to the Department as confidential, safeguard it accordingly and only use such Confidential Information for the purposes of this Agreement; and

(b) any person employed or engaged by it (in connection with this Agreement in the course of such employment or engagement) will not disclose any Confidential Information to any third party without prior written consent of the Department, except where disclosure is otherwise expressly permitted by the provisions of this Agreement.

23.2.2 The Employer must take all necessary precautions to ensure that all Confidential Information obtained from the Department is treated as confidential and not disclosed (without prior approval from the Department's Agreement Manager) or used other than for the purposes of this Agreement by any of its employees, servants, agents or Sub-Contractors.

23.2.3 The provisions of Clauses 23.2.1 and 23.2.2 will not apply to any information:

(a) which is or becomes public knowledge (other than by breach of Clauses 23.2.1 and 23.2.2);

(b) which was in the possession of the receiving party, without restriction as to its disclosure, before the date of receipt from the disclosing party;

(c) which must be disclosed pursuant to a statutory, legal or parliamentary obligation placed upon the party making the disclosure, including any requirements for disclosure under the FOIA or the Environmental Information Regulations.

23.2.4 Nothing in this Clause 23.2.4 will be deemed or construed to prevent the Department from disclosing any Confidential Information obtained from the Employer:

(a) to any other Central Government Body, Non-Departmental or Quasi Government Body or agency, central or local;

(b) to Parliament and Parliamentary Committees or if required by any Parliamentary reporting requirement;

(c) to any professional adviser, consultant, contractor or other person engaged by the Department directly in connection with this Agreement, provided that such information is treated as confidential by the receiving consultant, contractor or any other person;

(d) on a confidential basis to any proposed successor body in connection with any assignment disposal of its rights, obligations or liabilities under this Agreement.

23.2.5 In order to ensure that no unauthorised person gains access to any Confidential Information or any data obtained in the course of the Services, the Employer undertakes to maintain adequate security arrangements that meet the requirements of professional standards and best practice.

23.2.6 The Employer will immediately notify the Department of any breach of security in relation to Confidential Information and all data obtained in the course of the Services and will keep a record of such breaches. The Employer will use its best endeavours to recover such Confidential Information or data however it may be recorded. The Employer will co-operate with the Department in any investigation that the Department considers necessary to undertake as a result of any breach of security in relation to Confidential Information or data.

23.2.7 The Employer must, at its own expense, alter any security systems at any time during the Agreement Period at the Department's request if the Department reasonably believes the Employer has failed to comply with Clause 23.2.6.

23.2.8 The Department reserves the right to publish details of this Agreement and the payments made under it to comply with the Government's transparency requirements.

23.2.9 The provisions of this Clause 23 will apply for the Agreement Period and after its termination.

PART 5: WORKFORCE

24 EMPLOYEES

24.1 When employing or engaging a person to carry out teaching work (as defined in regulation 3 of the Teachers' Disciplinary (England) Regulation 2012), in respect of any Learners under the age of 19 and High Needs Learners aged up to 25 (as if those Learners were pupils for the purposes of the definition of teaching work in regulation 3 of the Teachers' Disciplinary (England) Regulations 2012) the Employer must comply with Part 3 (Safer Recruitment) of Keeping children safe in education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk).

24.2 The Employer will comply with Part 2 (The Management of Safeguarding) and Part 3 (Safer Recruitment) of Keeping children safe in education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) in order to ensure the Services are provided with a view to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of Children whether at the institution or in an environment outside the direct control but under the auspices of the Employer. In doing so, the Employer will have regard to any guidance published, from time to time, by the Secretary of State for Education which sets out the expectations in relation to safeguarding practice within further education institutions. References to 'must' in any such guidance will be treated as 'should' for the purposes of this Agreement, save for any references to legal requirements arising from the

Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006 in respect of referrals to the Disclosure and Barring Service.

24.3 The Employer will comply with Part 2 (The Management of Safeguarding) of Keeping children safe in education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) in order to ensure the Services are delivered with a view to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of High Needs Learners aged up 25 receiving education or training at their institution or under the auspices of the Employer in an environment outside the direct control of the Employer. This must include the adoption of safer recruitment procedures, as set out in Part 3 (Safer Recruitment) of Keeping children safe in education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk). In doing so, the Employer will make those arrangements as if such Learners were Children and the Employer will have regard to any guidance published, from time to time, by the Secretary of State for Education, which sets out the expectations in relation to safeguarding practice within further education institutions as if it applied to those Learners as if they were Children. References to 'must' in any such guidance will be treated as 'should' for the purposes of this Agreement, save for any references to legal requirements arising from the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006 in respect of referrals to the Disclosure and Barring Service.

24.4 The Employer must ensure it takes the following action in respect of all Employer Personnel and potential Employer Personnel whom in connection with the Employer's provision of the Services will or is likely to be in contact with Learners or who will have access to Learners information (other than the Department's employees):

24.4.1 they are questioned as to whether they have any Convictions or ASBOs;

24.4.2 the results are obtained of a background check with the DBS of the most extensive kind permitted by Law;

24.4.3 to the extent permitted by Law, a copy of the results of such a background check as is referred to in Clause 24.4.2 are provided to the Department on request;

24.4.4 in respect of potential Employer Personnel from overseas the Employer must comply with the following guidance Criminal records checks for overseas applicants - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk);

24.4.5 the Employer must take the above action before the relevant Employer Personnel or potential Employer Personnel commences any activities in relation to the Services.

24.5 The Employer must also ensure that

24.5.1 no person who appears on a Barred List following the results of a DBS background check will be employed or engaged in the performance of the Services; and

24.5.2 all its Sub-Contractors will comply with all reporting requirements to the DBS including those who will have access to Learners' information (other than the Department's employees).

24.6 In so far as permitted by Law, where the Employer has made a referral or provided information to the Disclosure and Barring Service in compliance with any duties of the Employer under the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006, the Employer will ensure that it informs the Department via the Contact Form: General Enquires at Education and Skills Funding Agency - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) that a referral has been made/information has been provided.

24.7 In the event that any Employer Personnel or any employee of any Sub-Contractor is added to a Barred List, the Employer must ensure that such member of staff will cease to be engaged in the Services or any activities connected with the Services.

24.8 The Employer will require Employer Personnel, including those handling learner information, to declare annually whether there has been a change in their circumstances relating to the background checks referred to in this Clause 24. Where the self-declaration indicates a change in circumstances relating to those background checks, the Employer will:

24.8.1 assess the risk of continuing to engage such member of Employer Personnel in the delivery of the Services;

24.8.2 request new background checks of such member of Employer Personnel as required by this Clause 24;

24.8.3 put in place appropriate actions to ensure Learners are safeguarded, including, but not limited to, extra supervision of the member of Employer Personnel, re-assignment to an area of the delivery of the Services that does not bring the member of Employer Personnel into regular contact with Learners and / or Learner information, or removal from the delivery of the Services of the member of Employer Personnel, until such time as the Employer has received the outcome of the background checks required under Clause 24.8.2 and has taken any action required as a result of the outcome of such background checks.

24.9 Pending the receipt by the Employer of the results of the background checks referred to in this Clause 24, Employer Personnel will not be used in the provision of the Services.

24.10 Failure by the Employer to comply with Clauses 24.4 to 24.9 will constitute a breach of agreement.

24.11 The Employer will provide details of its policies and procedures for recruitment, training, development, supervision and other employment-related policies when requested to do so.

24.12 The Employer will ensure that it has in place and complies with an effective whistleblowing procedure, approved by the body responsible for the management of the Employer, whereby staff may raise in confidence concerns about possible malpractice without fear of victimisation, subsequent discrimination or disadvantage. The procedure must be published on the Employer's public-facing website. The Employer will regularly review the procedure, including securing

approval from the body responsible for the management of the Employer of any amended procedure.

24.13 Unless Employer Personnel transfer to the Department and/or a Successor Employer under TUPE at expiry or termination of the Agreement, the Employer will retain employment records (or retain the right to access employment records) for seven (7) years following the last day such Employer Personnel were engaged in providing Services save for Employer Personnel in contact with Children and/or with access to information about Children where such records will be retained for fifteen (15) years following such date.

24.14 When requested by the Department on reasonable grounds, the Employer will cease to use any Employer Personnel specified by the Department in the provision of the Services. For the purposes of this clause Employer Personnel will include all members of the board including those who are not employees.

24.15 The Employer must ensure that:

24.15.1 there will be at all times a sufficient number of staff (including all relevant grades of supervisory staff) engaged in the provision of the Services with the requisite level of skill and experience. This obligation will include ensuring that there are sufficient staff to cover periods of holiday, sickness, other absences and anticipated and actual peaks in demand for each of the Services; and

24.15.2 all Employer Personnel receive such training and supervision as is necessary to ensure the proper performance of the Services under this Agreement.

24.16 The Employer must inform the Department if directors, or any other person who has powers of representation, decision or control, meet the characteristics set out in the Funding Higher-Risk Organisations and Sub-Contractors document. Department for Education policy on funding higher risk organisations and subcontractors - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk). Failure to inform the Department will be a breach of agreement.

24.17 Where the Agreement value is greater than £10,000,000, the Employer will consider the use of Apprenticeships in the delivery of the Services.

24.18 The Employer must ensure that it and any Sub-Contractors have in place and maintain personnel policies and procedures covering all relevant matters (including discipline, grievance, equal opportunities and health and safety). The Employer must ensure that the terms and implementation of such policies and procedures comply with Law and Good Industry Practice and that they are published in written form. The Employer must provide copies of such policies to the Department, on the Department's request.

25 RE-PROVISION OF THE SERVICES

25.1 The Department and the Employer will act on the basis that TUPE applies on expiry or termination of the Agreement where the Department is proposing re-provision for services which are substantially the same as the Services. For the avoidance of doubt this Clause 25 does not apply where the Employer will be providing the Services in the following Funding Year.

25.2 During the period of three (3) months preceding the expiry of the Agreement or within 21 days after the Department or the Employer has given notice to terminate the Agreement, the Employer will disclose to the Department and will permit the Department to disclose to any new employer or potential new employer of the services which are substantially the same as the Services, the Staffing Information provided that prior to so doing any such employer will have executed in writing a confidentiality undertaking in favour of the Employer.

25.3 During the period of three (3) months preceding the expiry of this Agreement or within 21 days after the Department or the Employer has given notice to terminate the Agreement, the Employer must, subject to the provisions of the UK GDPR and Data Protection Legislation, provide and thereafter keep updated at monthly intervals, to the Department and to the Successor Employer information equivalent to the Relevant Personnel Documentation and the Staffing Information in respect of each employee whom the Employer reasonably believes will be a Future Transferring Employee provided that prior to so doing the Successor Employer nominated by the Department will have executed in writing a confidentiality undertaking in favour of the Employer.

25.4 The Employer must make reasonable endeavours to assist the Successor Employer to communicate with, meet and inform and consult with the employees whom the Employer reasonably believes will be a Future Transferring Employee and their trade union or other employee representatives for the purposes of complying with TUPE.

25.5 The Employer must immediately prior to the Service Transfer Date provide to the Department or the Successor Employer a complete and accurate list of the Staffing Information and Identification Details of all employees whom it reasonably believes will be Future Transferring Employees.

25.6 Within a period of 21 days following the expiry or termination of this Agreement the Employer must provide to the Department or the Successor Employer in writing Final Pay Details of the Future Transferring Employees.

25.7 The Employer warrants that it will supply complete and accurate information pursuant to Clauses 25.2, 25.3, 25.5 and 25.6 in all material respects and the Employer will indemnify and keep the Department indemnified fully now and in the future in respect of all or any costs whether arising in Agreement or under any relevant Law suffered or incurred by the Department or the Successor Employer nominated by the Department by reason of any proceeding, claim or demand arising from or in connection with the provision of information and/or the failure to

provide complete and accurate information under Clauses 25.2, 25.3, 25.5, and 25.6, and/or the provision of assistance and/or failure to provide assistance under Clause 25.4 of this Agreement.

25.8 After receiving notice of the termination of this Agreement and for six (6) months preceding expiry of this Agreement the Employer will promptly notify the Department or the Successor Employer:

25.8.1 of the period of notice given by the employment of any employee whom the Employer reasonably believes will be a Future Transferring Employee; and

25.8.2 of any other change to any employee whom the Employer reasonably believes will be a Future Transferring Employee and their terms and conditions of employment, their Staffing Information and their Relevant Personnel Documentation.

25.9 The Employer warrants that it will supply the Required Information completely and accurately in all respects at the time of supply and will indemnify and keep the Department and/or any Successor Employer indemnified in respect of all and any costs suffered or incurred by the Department or the Successor Employer by reason of any proceedings, claim or demand arising out of or in connection with:

25.9.1 any claim against the Department or the Successor Employer by any Future Transferring Employee so far as it relates to any act or omission of the Employer after the Employee Transfer Date and prior to the Service Transfer Date; and

25.9.2 any claim against the Department or the Successor Employer by any Future Transferring Employee whose name is not included on the list provided by the Employer pursuant to Clause 25.5 so far as it relates to the dismissal of such Future Transferring Employee within two Months of the Department or Successor Employer becoming aware of the transfer of such Future Transferring Employee.

25.10 For the purposes of Clause 25.9, in the event that the Department or the Successor Employer incurs costs, liabilities or expenditure in respect of Future Transferring Employees which is greater than would have been the case if the Required Information supplied by the Employer had been accurate and complete, then such (net) greater costs, liabilities or expenditure will be deemed to be costs suffered or incurred by the Department or Successor Employer and included within the indemnity provided by the Employer.

25.11 The Department or Successor Employer will be entitled to recover from the Employer in full any legal, accountancy and other costs actually and reasonably incurred by the Department or Successor Employer in connection with the costs and liabilities indemnified by the Employer.

25.12 This Clause 25 will continue in effect for six (6) months following the expiry or termination of this Agreement.

PART 6: PAYMENT AND AUDIT

26 PAYMENT, FUNDING AND AUDIT

26.1 Payment, Funding and Audit provisions

26.1.1 In consideration of the Services to be provided by the Employer, the Department agrees to pay the Employer the amounts set out in Schedule 2 of this Agreement on condition that the Employer delivers the Services in accordance with the terms and conditions of this Agreement.

26.1.2 The Employer must use the Funding solely for the purpose of delivering the Services as set out in this Agreement.

26.1.3 The Employer will comply with the Funding Rules published by the Department as amended from time to time.

26.1.4 The Department reserves the right to impose additional conditions of funding where it considers it is necessary to do so to secure the delivery of education and training of a reasonable quality by the Employer, or to ensure that the resources provided by the Department are being used effectively and efficiently or to require the Employer to address concerns about its financial viability or to ensure that the Employer complies with requests made by the Department under the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework.

26.1.5 The payment of Funding by the Department will be without prejudice to any claims or rights, which the Department may have against the Employer and will not constitute any admission by the Department as to the performance by the Employer of its obligations under this Agreement. Prior to any such payment of Funding, the Department shall be entitled to make deductions or deferments in respect of any disputes or claims whatsoever with or against the Employer, arising from this Agreement or any other agreement between the Employer and the Department.

26.1.6 The Department shall be entitled to terminate, pursuant to Clause 35.3.8 of this Agreement on written notice if the Employer does not recruit and/or data returns reveal that no Learners have been enrolled for the funding year to which this Agreement relates. Where the Department terminates the Agreement under this Clause 26.1.6, the Department will withdraw the allocation of Funding for the Funding Year and will take action to recover Funds where payments have already occurred.

26.1.7 Where the Department identifies errors which it deems to be material in the data that the Employer is required to provide under the Agreement to support the payment of Funding, the Department reserves the right at its absolute discretion to require the Employer at the Employer's cost to carry out a 100% audit of all or part of the Services by a deadline specified by the Department and / or to require the Employer to repay Funding equivalent to the full amount of the Funding that has been wrongly

claimed or paid. If only a sample of the Services has been audited, the Department reserves the right to calculate an error rate based on the said sample and claim repayment from the Employer of an extrapolated amount based on the error rate identified and the total value of the Funding paid to the Employer under this Agreement.

26.1.8 Without prejudice to any other provisions in this Agreement, at the Department's discretion, such amounts as are identified as being recoverable under Clause 26.1.7, may be recovered by making adjustments to data submitted by the Employer under the Agreement, or by raising an invoice for payment by the Employer, or by making deductions from future payments due to the Employer under the Agreement. Failure to settle such amounts by the Employer will constitute a breach of agreement. The decision of the Department as to the amount of recovery under this Clause 26.1 (Payment, Funding and Audit provisions) is final.

26.1.9 Where the Department, in accordance with Clause 26.1.7, identifies errors it may at its discretion review the controls and processes to gain assurance the errors will not occur again. Where further assurance work is required this will be at the Employer's cost (or the Department will procure and recharge to the Employer at its sole discretion). Where a full funding audit results in a "qualified" rating this will constitute a breach of agreement.

26.1.10 The Department may implement a reduction in funding as set out in the Funding Rules through a notification and not a variation pursuant to Clause 44 (Amendments to this Agreement).

26.1.11 Where the Department identifies that the allocated Funding has been miscalculated and that the Employer has been overpaid as a result, the Department will notify the Employer in writing of the amount of the overpayment, the date when the Department will seek to recover the Funding and the method of recovery such as being through an invoice or through setting off the overpayment against future payments of the Funding.

26.1.12 If the Employer wants to make representations in relation to the notification it received in accordance with Clause 26.1.11, the Employer must put them in writing within 5 Working Days of the date the notification received from the Department. The Employer may make representations to the Department where it has incurred in good faith costs or liability in excess of the amount of allocated Funding that the Department has now notified as being the correct amount of Funding that the Employer should have been allocated.

26.1.13 The Department will consider any representations made by the Employer in accordance with Clause 26.1.12 and issue the Employer with written notification of its final decision including the amount of overpayment of Funding to be repaid, the date when

the Department will recover the Funding and the method of recovery. The Department will also set out the basis on which it has made its decision and shall include an amended Schedule 2 setting out the corrected Funding allocation.

26.1.14 The decision of the Department as to the amount of recovery of Funding that it is due to it from the Employer is final.

26.1.15 All payments by the Department will be made via BACS.

Tax Compliance

26.1.16 The Department may ask the Employer to provide information which demonstrates how the Employer complies with the Income Tax (Earnings and Pensions) Act 2003 and all other statutes and regulations relating to income tax in respect of that consideration.

26.1.17 The Department may terminate this Agreement if:

(a) in the case of a request mentioned in Clause 26.1.16 the Employer:

(i) fails to provide information in response to the request within a reasonable time; or

(ii) provides information which does not demonstrate either how the Employer complies with Clauses 26.1.16 and 26.1.19 or why those clauses do not apply to it;

(iii) it receives information which demonstrates that is not complying with its obligations under the Income Tax (Earnings and Pensions) Act 2003 and all other statutes and regulations relating to income tax.

26.1.18 The Department may supply any information which it receives under Clause 26.1.16 to HMRC.

26.1.19 If, during the Agreement Period, an Occasion of Tax Non-Compliance occurs, the Employer will:

(a) notify the Department in writing of such fact within 5 Working Days of its occurrence; and

(b) promptly give the Department:

(i) details of the steps it is taking to address the Occasion of Tax Non-Compliance and to prevent the same from recurring, together with any mitigating factors it considers relevant; and

(ii) such other information in relation to the Occasion of Tax Non-Compliance as the Department may reasonably require.

27 REVIEW OF CONTRACTUAL PERFORMANCE AND RECONCILIATION OF AGREEMENTS

27.1 In-Year Reconciliation

27.1.1 Reviews of contractual performance and reconciliation will be carried out in accordance with part 1B of Schedule 1 (Specification and Monitoring).

27.1.2 The evidence required in respect of each Learning Programme is set out in the Funding Rules and the Employer must retain such evidence for inspection on demand.

27.2 Performance

27.2.1 Performance will be monitored in accordance with the provisions of part 1B of Schedule 1 (Specification and Monitoring).

27.2.2 The Department will be able to share allocations and performance information with Combined Authorities, Crown Bodies and LEPs.

28 EMPLOYER'S RECORDS AND AUDIT

28.1 Maintenance of Records

28.1.1 The Employer must, and will procure that any Employer Related Parties, maintain a full record of all incidents relating to data protection, health, safety and security, including CCTV, which occur during the Agreement Period. The Employer will make the aforementioned records available for inspection by the Department upon reasonable notice, and will present a report of them to the Department as and when requested.

28.2 Auditor

28.2.1 The Department (in accordance with Post-16 audit code of practice - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)), the European Commission, the European Court of Auditors and/or a Crown Body may at any time conduct audits for the following purposes:-

(a) to establish that the Employer has used the Funding (and proposed or actual variations to the Funding in accordance with this Agreement) in the delivery of the Services and/or the costs of all suppliers (including Sub-Contractors) of the Services;

(b) to verify the Employer's claims for Funding;

(c) to review the integrity, confidentiality and security of the Department Data as well as the Department's access to the Department Data;

(d) to review the Employer's and/or an Employer Related Party's compliance with the DPA 2018, the FOIA in accordance with Clauses 19 (Department Data) and 23 (Freedom of Information and Confidentiality) and any other Law applicable to the Services;

(e) to carry out the audit and certification of the Department's accounts;

(f) to verify the accuracy and completeness of any management information delivered or required by this Agreement;

(g) to ensure that the Employer and/or an Employer Related Party is complying with the Department Policies and any British or equivalent European standards and any other audit that may be required by any Relevant Authority,

such audits may be based on current or preceding years or preceding Agreements.

28.2.2 The Department will use its reasonable endeavours to ensure that the conduct of each audit does not unreasonably disrupt the Employer or delay the provision of the Services.

28.2.3 Subject to the Department's obligations of confidentiality, the Employer and/or an Employer Related Party must on demand provide the Department (and/or its agents or representatives) with all reasonable co-operation and assistance in relation to each audit, including:-

(a) all information requested by the Department within the permitted scope of the audit;

(b) reasonable access to any premises and any equipment used (whether exclusively or non-exclusively) in the performance of the Services;

(c) access to the Employer's and/or an Employer Related Party's systems;

(d) access to Employer Personnel; and

(e) provision of any accounting records as referred to in Section 386 of the Companies Act 2006 and/or financial records as the Department may require which if the Employer is not a company may include similar accounting records as are referred to in Section 386 of the Companies Act 2006.

28.2.4 The Employer will implement all measurement and monitoring tools and procedures necessary to measure and report on the Employer's (including for the avoidance of doubt an Employer Related Party's) performance of the Services.

28.2.5 The Department will endeavour to (but is not obliged to) provide at least ten (10) Working Days' notice of its intention to conduct an audit. The Department may carry out audit visits with or without prior notice at its discretion.

28.2.6 The Parties agree that they will bear their own respective costs and expenses incurred in respect of compliance with their obligations under this clause, unless the audit identifies a material breach or malpractice by the Employer and/or an Employer

Related Party in which case the Employer will reimburse the Department for all the Department's reasonable costs incurred in the course of the audit.

28.2.7 If the findings of an audit conducted pursuant to this Clause 28 results in the requirement for ILR data to be corrected and re-submitted the Employer must re-submit the data to the Department, as set out in Clause 21 (Submission of Learner Data), within two months. Failure to do so will be a breach of agreement.

28.2.8 If the Department identifies that:-

(a) the Employer has failed to perform its obligations under this Agreement in any material manner, without prejudice to any other remedy that the Department has, the Parties will agree and implement a remedial plan. If the Employer's failure relates to a failure to provide any information to the Department about the Funding, proposed Funding or the Employer's costs, then the remedial plan will include a requirement for the provision of all such information;

(b) there has been any under or over payment it will be dealt with in accordance with Clause 26.1 (Funding and Payment).

28.2.9 The Employer must permit records referred to in this Clause 28 (Employer's Records and Audit) to be examined and copied from time to time by the Department's auditor and inspectors and their representatives and other representatives of the Department.

28.3 Retention

28.3.1 The records referred to in this Clause 28 (Employer's Records and Audit) will be retained for a period of at least six (6) years, subject to any requirements for a longer retention period set out in the Funding Rules, after the end of the Agreement Period.

28.4 Information on Termination or Expiry

28.4.1 Upon termination or expiry of this Agreement the Employer must (and will ensure that the Sub-Contractors will) comply with all reasonable requests of the Department to provide information relating to the Employer's costs of providing the Services.

28.5 Confidentiality of Information

28.5.1 All information referred to in this Clause 28 (Employer's Records and Audit) is subject to the obligations set out in Clause 23.2 (Confidentiality) and Clause 23.1 (Freedom of Information).

28.5.2 For the purposes of the examination and certification of the Department's accounts and/or any examination of the economy, efficiency and effectiveness with which the Department has used its resources, the National Audit Office, internal or external auditor may examine such documents premises, systems and staff as they may reasonably require which are owned, held or otherwise

within the control or employ of the Employer or Sub-Contractors (who must ensure that any person acting on its behalf who has such documents and/or other information will also provide access) and may require the Employer to produce such oral or written explanation as they consider necessary.

28.5.3 Where the Department appoints an independent third party to undertake, exercise or carry out any of the rights or powers contained in this Clause 28 (Employer's Records and Audit) the Department must ensure that such independent third party enters into a Confidentiality Agreement with the Employer simultaneously with its appointment.

29 SUBSIDY CONTROL

29.1 The Employer should satisfy itself, if the Subsidy Control Rules apply to the Funding received in relation to the Services delivered under this Agreement. Guidance on this can be found at Complying with the UK's international obligations on subsidy control: guidance for public authorities - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk).

29.2 Where the rules on Subsidy Control apply, the Employer will collect and retain appropriate records and will supply those records to the Department on its request.

29.3 The Department reserves the right to require the Employer to obtain a contribution towards the cost of the Services delivered under this Agreement from the employer of any Learner. Where a contribution is required, the Department will confirm to the Employer in writing the exact percentage of the contribution.

29.4 Where the Department requires the Employer to obtain a contribution towards the cost of the Services under Clause 29.3 above, the Employer must provide evidence that the contribution has been received.

29.5 In the event that any funding paid under this Agreement is deemed to constitute unlawful subsidy control the Department reserves the right to require immediate repayment of any such funding.

PART 7: CORPORATE GENERAL

30 SUB-CONTRACTING

30.1 The Employer may enter into Sub-Contracts provided it does so in compliance with Schedule 1 (Specification and Monitoring) and Schedule 9 (Sub-Contracting).

30.2 Notwithstanding any arrangements the Employer has entered into with any Sub-Contractor, the Employer shall not be relieved or excused of responsibility or liability under this Agreement nor shall performance of its obligations be affected by the appointment of any Sub-Contractor.

30.3 If the Employer does not Sub-Contract, the Employer must still provide a nil return via the Sub-Contractor Declaration to confirm this.

30.4 Failure to comply with any of the requirements under Clauses 30.1 to 30.3 may result in the Department taking such actions as it deems appropriate, which may include, but is not limited to, action under Clause 34 (Withholding, Suspension and Repayment of Funding) and / or termination under Clause 35 (Termination).

31 INDEMNITIES AND LIABILITY

31.1 Employer Indemnity

31.1.1 The Employer will be responsible for, and will release and indemnify the Department, its employees and agents on demand from and against all liability from:

(a) death or personal injury caused by its negligence or that of its employees, agents or Sub-Contractors (as applicable);

(b) breach of statutory duty;

(c) third party actions, claims or demands brought against the Department as a direct consequence of the Employer's breach of this Agreement;

(d) fraud or fraudulent misrepresentation by it, its employees, agents or Sub-Contractors (as applicable);

(e) loss of or damage to property;

to the extent which the same may arise out of, or in consequence of:

(f) the performance or non-performance by the Employer of its obligations under this Agreement; and

(g) In all other respects, any negligent act, default or breach of statutory duty in connection with the performance or non-performance by the Employer of its obligations under this Agreement.

31.2 Employer Not Responsible

31.2.1 The Employer will not be responsible for or obliged to indemnify the Department for any injury, loss, damage, cost and expense caused by the negligence or wilful misconduct of the Department or by the breach by the Department of its obligations under this Agreement.

31.3 Limitation of Indemnity

31.3.1 Subject to Clause 31.9, an indemnity by either Party under any provision of this Agreement will be without limitation to any indemnity by that Party under any other provision of this Agreement.

31.4 Responsibility for Related Parties

31.4.1 The Employer will be responsible as against the Department for the acts or omissions of the Employer Related Parties as if they were the acts or omissions of the Employer and the Department will be responsible as against the Employer for the acts or omissions of Department Related Parties as if they were the acts or omissions of the Department.

31.5 Notification of Claims

31.5.1 Where either Party (the "Indemnified Party") wishes to make a claim under this Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability) against the other (the "Indemnifying Party") in relation to a claim made against it by a third party (a "Third Party Claim"), the Indemnified Party will give notice of the relevant claim as soon as reasonably practicable setting out full particulars of the claim.

31.6 Conduct of Claims

31.6.1 The Indemnifying Party may at its own expense and with the assistance and co-operation of the Indemnified Party have the conduct of the Third Party Claim including its settlement and the Indemnified Party will not, unless the Indemnifying Party has failed to resolve the Third Party Claim within a reasonable period (and the Indemnified Party has notified the Indemnifying Party in writing that it is of the opinion that such reasonable period has expired), take any action to settle or pursue the Third Party Claim.

31.7 Costs of Claims

31.7.1 The Indemnifying Party may, if it wishes to have conduct of any claim, give reasonable security to the Indemnified Party for any cost or liability arising out of the conduct of the claim by the Indemnifying Party.

31.7.2 The Employer's liability to the Department pursuant to this Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability) will be, for the avoidance of doubt, without prejudice to any other right or remedy available to the Department under this Agreement.

31.8 No Limit on Liability

31.8.1 Neither Party excludes or limits its liability to the other Party for:

(a) death or personal injury caused by its negligence, or that of its employees, agents or Sub-Contractors (as applicable); or

(b) any breach of any obligations implied by Section 12 of the Sale of Goods Act 1979 or Section 2 of the Supply of Goods and Services Act 1982; or

(c) fraud by it, fraud by its employees, fraud by its agents or Sub-Contractors (as applicable); or

(d) sums due under Clause 25 (Re-provision of the Services); or

(e) any breach of the DPA 2018.

31.9 Employer Limit on Liability

31.9.1 Subject to Clauses 31.2 (Employer Not Responsible) and 31.8 (No Limit on Liability) the liability of the Employer for the Agreement Period will be Ten Million Pounds (£10,000,000) in aggregate in respect of all claims, losses or damages, whether arising under any indemnity from tort (including negligence), breach of agreement or otherwise under or in connection with this Agreement.

31.10 Employer Aggregate Liability

31.10.1 If the aggregate liability of the Employer under Clause 31.9 (Employer Limit on Liability) is equalled or exceeded at any time during the Agreement Period, it will entitle the Department at its discretion to terminate this Agreement pursuant to Clause 35.4 (Termination).

31.11 Department Limit on Liability

31.11.1 With regard to the Department the total aggregate liability for the Agreement Period will be limited to its obligation to pay the Funding as and when it falls due in accordance with this Agreement.

31.12 Indirect Loss

31.12.1 Neither Party will be liable to the other Party for any Indirect Loss or indirect damage.

31.13 Additional Clauses

31.13.1 The Parties expressly agree that if any limitation or provision contained or expressly referred to in this Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability) is held to be invalid under any Law, it will be deemed omitted to that extent, and if any party becomes liable for loss or damage to which that limitation or provision applied, that liability will be subject to the remaining limitations and provisions set out in this Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability).

31.13.2 Nothing in this Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability) will act to reduce or affect a Party's general duty to mitigate its loss and for the avoidance of doubt including any circumstances under which a party has the benefit of an indemnity under this Agreement.

31.14 No Double Recovery

31.14.1 Neither the Department nor the Employer will be entitled to recover compensation or make a claim under this Agreement in respect of any loss that it or they has or have incurred to the extent that the Party has already been compensated in respect of that loss pursuant to this Agreement or otherwise.

32 INSURANCE

32.1 Requirement to Maintain

32.1.1 Without prejudice to its liability to indemnify the Department under Clause 31 (Indemnities and Liability) the Employer must take out and maintain in force or procure the taking out and maintenance of the Required Insurances and any other insurances as may be required by Law. The insurances will be effective in each case no later than the date on which the relevant risk commences.

32.1.2 The Required Insurances referred to in Clause 32.1.1 will amount to:

(a) ten million pounds (£10 million) in respect of public liability cover in respect of each and every occurrence;

(b) ten million pounds (£10 million) in respect of employer's liability cover in respect of each and every occurrence; and

(c) five million pounds (£5 million) in respect of professional indemnity cover in respect of each and every claim.

32.1.3 The Department reserves the right, at any time, to request evidence that the Required Insurances are in force.

33 PROHIBITED ACTS

33.1 The Employer will not offer or give, or agree to give, to any member, employee or representative of the Secretary of State for Education any gift or consideration of any kind as an inducement or reward for doing or refraining from doing, or for having done or refrained from doing, any act in relation to the obtaining or execution of this Agreement or any other Agreement with the Department or for showing or refraining from showing favour or disfavour to any person in relation to this Agreement or any such Agreement.

33.2 The Employer's attention is drawn to the criminal offences created by the Bribery Act 2010. Any offence by the Employer or its employees or by anyone acting on its behalf under the Bribery Act 2010 in relation to this Agreement or any Agreement with the Department or His Majesty's Government will entitle the Department to terminate the Agreement and recover from the Employer the amount of any loss resulting from such termination and/or to recover from the Employer the amount of value of any gift, consideration or commission.

33.3 The Employer must not use any Funding provided by the Department under this Agreement for any of the purposes set out in paragraph 16 of the Cabinet Office: Guidance for General Grants Grants-Standard-SIX-Grant-Agreements.pdf (publishing.service.gov.uk) regardless of whether the Funding consists of a general grant or any other type of grant. For the avoidance of doubt, the Employer's costs of memberships for their Associations are deemed eligible under the terms of the Agreement.

33.4 The Employer will not hold itself out as acting on behalf of the Department without the Department's permission.

PART 8: TERMINATION AND EXIT MANAGEMENT

34 WITHHOLDING, SUSPENSION AND REPAYMENT OF FUNDING

34.1 Without prejudice to the Department's other rights and remedies, the Department may at its discretion withhold or suspend payment of Funding if one or more of the following applies:

34.1.1 the Employer materially breaches any of the terms or conditions of this Agreement;

34.1.2 the Department, acting reasonably, has concerns:

34.1.2.1 about the standard of Services that the Employer is delivering or has delivered including in respect of one or more standard or framework; and / or

34.1.2.2 that the quality of leadership at the Employer is such that one or more Learner has no reasonable prospect of achieving their training objective; and / or

34.1.2.3 that Learners may be at risk on safeguarding grounds;

34.1.3 an Awarding Organisation is taking remedial and / or enforcement action against the Employer;

34.1.4 the Department has reasonable grounds to suspect fraud, financial irregularity, dishonesty, negligence or practice by any of the Employer and / or one or more Employer Related Party;

34.1.5 the Department has concerns about the completeness, accuracy or promptness of the data submitted by the Employer on the ILR in relation to this Agreement or, subject to Clause 34.3 any other agreement;

34.1.6 any employee of the Employer or any other Employer Related Party has acted or failed to act in a way which, in the reasonable opinion of the Department, brings or is likely to bring the Department's name, brand or reputation or the Apprenticeships brand into disrepute;

34.1.7 the Employer was not entitled to Funding under the Funding Rules in relation to one or more Learner;

34.1.8 there occurs, in respect of the Employer, any Insolvency Event which, in the reasonable opinion of the Department, may affect the Employer's ability to comply with its obligations under this Agreement; and / or

34.1.9 the Employer fails to comply with any of the provisions set out in this Agreement (including the provisions in the Funding Rules and / or any requirements under the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework) and fails to rectify any such failure within 30 days of

receiving written notice from the Department (or such other timescale specified in the notice) detailing the failure and requiring it to rectify the failure.

34.2 A right to withhold, suspend and / or require repayment of the Funding is set out in other provisions in this Agreement.

34.3 If under Clause 34.1.5 some or all of the Department's concerns about the completeness, accuracy or promptness of data relate to data submitted under an agreement other than this Agreement, then such concerns are relevant to the extent that they undermine the Department's confidence in the Employer's ability to comply with its obligations to submit complete or accurate or prompt data in relation to this Agreement.

34.4 The right to suspend Funding in accordance with Clause 34.1 includes the right to:

34.4.1 suspend the payment of Funding to the Employer in relation to current Learners for a specified period; and / or

34.4.2 not consider any applications or pay any Funding for new Learners for a specified period.

34.5 Where the Department suspends Funding in accordance with the terms of this Agreement, it shall notify the Employer in writing of the suspension and its duration as well as the intervals at which the suspension will be reviewed to see whether the suspension should be withdrawn or extended.

34.6 The Department reserves the right to recover from the Employer any Funding paid to an Employer where the payment of Funding or any arrangement between the employer of apprentices under an Apprenticeship, and the Employer breaches the Funding Rules or the entitlement to Funding was based on wrong, inaccurate or misleading information.

35 TERMINATION

35.1 On the occurrence of any of the events described in this Clause 35 the Department will be entitled to terminate this Agreement by notice to the Employer with immediate effect.

35.2 Either Party may terminate this Agreement with immediate effect in the event that in the reasonable opinion of the Party wishing to terminate this Agreement, the conduct of the other in performing its obligations under this Agreement amounts to a material breach of agreement, which is incapable of remedy. For the avoidance of doubt this will include but not be limited to:

35.2.1 an Insolvency Event affecting the Employer occurs; or

35.2.2 if Regulation 73(1) (b) of The Public Contracts Regulations 2015 applies to the Employer; or

35.2.3 the Employer commits one or more Prohibited Acts; or

35.2.4 any other Employer breach has occurred that is incapable of remedy.

35.3 The Department reserves the right to terminate this Agreement with immediate effect by giving notice in writing if:

35.3.1 the Employer ceases to be on the Register of Apprenticeship Training Providers maintained by the Department; and/or

35.3.2 the Employer fails to comply with requirements imposed under Clauses 10.11.1(a) and/or 10.11.1(b); and/or

35.3.3 the Employer fails to comply with requirements imposed under Clauses 12.3 or 12.5; and/or

35.3.4 an inspection results in the Services in part or overall thereof being assessed as inadequate; and/or

35.3.5 in accordance with Clause 12.9.5 an Inspectorate monitoring visit results in the Services being assessed as having made “insufficient progress” and in the reasonable view of the Department Learners may be at immediate risk on safeguarding grounds, and/or the quality of leadership and/or training provision is such that one or more Learner has no reasonable prospect of achieving their training objective; and/or

35.3.6 in accordance with Clause 12.9.6 the Employer has had two consecutive Ofsted Monitoring Visits resulting in one or more “insufficient progress” judgements; and/or

35.3.7 the Employer receives a “qualified” rating in two consecutive full funding audits; and/or

35.3.8 in accordance with Clause 26.1.6 the Employer does not recruit and/or data returns reveal that no Learners have been enrolled for the funding year to which this Agreement relates; and/or

35.3.9 the Employer fails to provide information as set out in Clause 26.1.17 and/or the Department receives information which demonstrates that the Employer is not complying with its obligations under the Income Tax (Earnings and Pensions) Act 2003 and all other statutes and regulations relating to income tax; and/or

35.3.10 the Employer commits a material breach of Clause 30; and/or

35.3.11 the Employer commits a material breach of Clause 33.3; and/or

35.3.12 where any of the circumstances set out in Clause 34 (Withholding, Suspension and Repayment of Funding) occur which amount to a material breach of this Agreement; and/or

35.3.13 if the Services delivered under this Agreement, are below any performance expectations set out in the Apprenticeship Accountability Framework to the extent to which it amounts to a material breach.

35.4 The Department will be entitled to terminate this Agreement immediately on the grounds set out in Clause 31.10. In the event of any termination in

accordance with Clause 31.10, the Exit Arrangements set out in Clause 37 (Exit Arrangements) and Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements) will apply.

35.5 This Agreement will be voidable where, following an evaluation of the last three (3) years' Data Submissions relating to any other Agreement with the Department, the Department concludes that the Employer was in material breach of that Agreement or Agreements and if the Department had known at the time of awarding and/or entering into this Agreement that the Employer had committed a material breach, it would not have awarded and/or entered into this Agreement.

35.6 If the circumstances set out in Clause 35.5 arise and the Agreement is declared void, the parties will be deemed to have subsequently entered into a new legally binding agreement that includes the provisions set out in the table at Clause 52.1.2.

35.7 If the Department terminates another Agreement with the Employer on fault grounds where a similar right of termination also exists in this Agreement in relation to similar provisions, the Department, acting reasonably, may immediately give notice of termination of this Agreement in writing to the Employer.

35.8 In addition to the rights of termination under any other clauses of this Agreement, either Party will be entitled to terminate this Agreement in respect of all or part of the Service provided under the Agreement by giving to the other not less than three months' notice to that effect.

35.9 Termination under this Clause 35 will not prejudice or affect any right of action or remedy, which will have accrued or will thereupon accrue to the Parties under this Agreement.

35.10 Where the Employer goes into administration or liquidation, the Department must be assumed to be a creditor of the Employer. The Employer must take steps to ensure that the Department is provided with details of the administrator or liquidator and receives notification of any creditors meetings. The Department will confirm whether in fact it is a creditor within 12 weeks of being notified that the Employer is in administration or liquidation.

35.11 The Employer must upon notice of termination of the Agreement make available upon request to the Department all Learner files (including but not limited to e-portfolios), correspondence, documents, specification papers and other property belonging to the Department, which may be in its possession or under its control.

35.12 Notice of termination of the Agreement under this Clause 35 will result in the Employer being removed from the Register of Apprenticeship Training Providers.

35.13 The Employer must not recruit new Learners, including Learners that have transferred from another provider, after notice of termination of the Agreement has been given. The Department will not be liable to make payments in respect of any Learners recruited in breach of this clause.

36 CONSEQUENCES OF TERMINATION AND EXPIRY

36.1 Accrued Rights

36.1.1 The termination of this Agreement howsoever arising is without prejudice to the rights, duties and liabilities of either Party accrued prior to termination. The clauses of this Agreement which expressly or impliedly have effect after termination or expiry will continue to be enforceable notwithstanding termination in accordance with Clause 52 (Continuing Obligations).

36.1.2 On or before the Expiry Date (except where the Employer will be responsible for delivering the Services in the subsequent Funding Year) or Termination Date, the Employer must ensure that all documents or computer records in its possession, custody or control including but not limited to e-portfolios, which contain information relating to the Services including any documents in the possession, custody or control of a Sub-Contractor are made available upon request to the Department.

36.1.3 For the avoidance of doubt, after notice of termination and/or an Insolvency Event affecting the Employer, the Employer must not share any information about Learners, including but not limited to Department Data, with another organisation unless the Department provides written authorisation for the Employer to do so. In addition, the Employer shall not recruit Learners from another Employer that has been issued with a notice of termination and/or in relation to whom an Insolvency Event has occurred, without the permission of the Department.

36.1.4 The Employer hereby grants the Department a non-exclusive licence to access the Employer's Premises from the date of a notice of termination for such periods as may be reasonably necessary to enable the Department to retrieve the information referred to in Clause 36.1.2. The Department will exercise the rights provided under this clause where the Employer has failed to comply with Clause 36.1.2 and the obligations set out in Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements).

36.1.5 The termination or expiry of this Agreement shall be without prejudice to rights of either Party accrued prior to the Termination Date or Expiry Date and shall not affect the continuing rights of the Parties under any provision of the Agreement that either expressly or by implication has effect after the Termination Date or the Expiry Date.

36.1.6 The Department reserves the right to retain Funding that would otherwise be paid to the Employer prior to the Expiry Date or Termination Date and/or to demand repayment of Funding, as relevant, in order to reconcile what has already been paid to the Employer under Schedule 2 (Payments) with the amount the Employer is entitled to under this Agreement (including the Funding Rules).

36.1.7 Where this Agreement is terminated or expires, the Department may elect to take the role of Data Controller to secure and protect Learner Files, Learner Records and/or Evidence Packs, including e-portfolios until the Learner information can be transferred to a new Provider, the Learner, or destroyed in accordance with defined retention periods. If the Department elects to assume this role, the Employer shall co-operate fully to facilitate this.

37 EXIT ARRANGEMENTS

37.1 The Department and the Employer must, unless the Employer will be responsible for delivering the Services in the following Funding Year, comply with the exit arrangements set out in Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements) and any current Exit Plan.

37.2 On expiry or termination of this Agreement for any reason, the Employer shall do its utmost to minimise any disruption to Learners and shall co-operate fully with any reasonable requests made by the Department relating to this. For the avoidance of doubt the Department will be entitled to request that where the Employer cannot complete Learners that it will co-operate in transferring the Learners to a new provider even if this is prior to the Termination Date or Expiry Date of this Agreement and the Employer's Exit Plan should reflect this. The Department will not be liable for any costs prior to or after the Termination Date or Expiry Date incurred by the Employer in complying with this Clause 37.2.

37.3 Unless the Department otherwise requires, during the time between service of a notice of termination of this Agreement in whole or in part and such termination taking effect, the Employer must take all steps, which are necessary and consistent with its continuing obligations, to mitigate any losses, costs, liabilities and expenses which the Employer may incur as a result of the termination, including to:

37.3.1 cancel all capital and recurring cost commitments in connection with the provision of the Services on the most cost-effective terms without fettering the Department's access to Department Data and the Database;

37.3.2 terminate all relevant Agreements or the relevant parts of relevant Agreements with its Sub-Contractors in connection with the provision of Services on the most favourable terms as can be achieved in the particular circumstances, having first ascertained from the Department whether such Agreements are required to be transferred to the Department or any Successor Employer instead; and

37.3.3 reduce labour costs by the redeployment or release of Employer's Personnel to the extent possible in the circumstances.

37.4 If the Employer does not fulfil its obligations in accordance with Clause 37.3, the Department will not pay any sums in excess of those which the Department would have paid had such action been taken.

37.5 If the Employer does not co-operate with the Department in relation to exit in accordance with this Clause 37 and the Department incurs additional expenditure of any description as a result, the Department reserves the right to require the Employer to reimburse the Department for this additional expenditure.

PART 9: GENERAL PROVISIONS

38 PROVISION OF INFORMATION

38.1 The Department may share information provided by the Employer under this Agreement and information about the Employer or Agreement, with other Government departments, Crown Bodies, Inspectorates, Combined Authorities and local authorities.

38.2 In addition to the other requirements to provide information set out in this Agreement, the Department reserves the right to request information from the Employer in order to exercise its responsibilities and/or to fulfil requirements to provide information to the Secretary of State, to account to Parliament and to meet European funding requirements (where applicable). On occasion, the Department will require urgent information from the Employer.

38.3 The Employer must provide the Department or agents acting on its behalf with the information it requires under Clause 38.2 at the times and in the formats specified. This information will be of sufficient quality to meet the purposes for which it has been requested.

38.4 Failure to comply with any request for information under this clause, at all or in the required timescales, will constitute a breach of agreement.

39 SERVICE OF NOTICES

39.1 Any notice or other document to be given under this Agreement must be in writing and personally delivered, emailed, sent through the Department's electronic portal or sent by first class post to the address of the relevant party, as referred to above or in the case of an email address or correspondence address, as notified by the relevant party in writing from time to time. The notice or communication will be considered delivered as follows:

39.1.1 If personally delivered, when handed over to the addressee;

39.1.2 if sent by email or through the Department's electronic portal, on the day the email is sent if sent on a Working Day and before 5.00 pm, otherwise the email will be deemed delivered at 9.00 am on the next Working Day;

39.1.3 if sent by first class post, on the second Working Day after the day on which it is posted.

39.2 All such notices and communications must be in the English language. To prove the giving of a notice or other document it will be sufficient to show that it was despatched.

40 ENTIRE AGREEMENT

40.1 Prior Representations Superseded

40.1.1 Except where expressly provided in this Agreement, this Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the Parties in connection with its subject matter and supersedes all prior representations, communications, negotiations and understandings concerning the subject matter of this Agreement.

40.2 Acknowledgements

40.2.1 Each of the Parties acknowledges that:

(a) it does not enter into this Agreement on the basis of and does not rely, and has not relied, upon any statement or representation (whether negligent or innocent) or warranty or other provision (in any case whether oral, written, express or implied) made or agreed to by any person (whether a Party to this Agreement or not) except those expressly repeated or referred to in this Agreement and the only remedy or remedies available in respect of any misrepresentation or untrue statement made to it will be any remedy available under this Agreement; and

(b) this clause will not apply to any statement, representation or warranty made fraudulently, or to any provisions of this Agreement which was induced by fraud, for which the remedies available will be all those available under the Law governing this Agreement.

41 NO AGENCY

41.1 No Partnership or Employment

41.1.1 Nothing in this Agreement will be construed as creating a partnership or as an Agreement of employment between the Department and the Employer.

41.2 Power to Bind

41.2.1 Save as expressly provided otherwise in this Agreement, the Employer must not be, or be deemed to be, an agent of the Department and the Employer will not hold itself out as having authority or power to bind the Department in any way.

42 EXERCISE OF STATUTORY AUTHORITY

42.1 Nothing in this Agreement will be construed as a fetter or restriction on the exercise by the Department of its statutory functions.

43 PUBLIC RELATIONS AND PUBLICITY

43.1 The Employer must by itself, its employees or agents and procure that its Sub-Contractors must:

43.1.1 inform the Department of any communications with representatives of the press, television, radio or other communications media on any matter concerning this Agreement; and

43.1.2 not use or make use of the Department's name, logo or other branding without the prior written approval of the Department, which should not be unreasonably delayed or withheld.

44 AMENDMENTS TO THIS AGREEMENT

44.1 This Agreement will not be amended unless such amendment has been agreed in writing. For the avoidance of doubt this will include any amendments required to effect a Change agreed in accordance with Clause 6 (Changes).

45 WAIVER

45.1 No term or provision of this Agreement will be considered as waived by any Party to this Agreement unless a waiver is given in writing by that Party.

45.2 No waiver under Clause 45.1 will be a waiver of a past or future default or breach, nor will it amend, delete or add to the terms, conditions or provisions of this Agreement unless (and then only to the extent) expressly stated in that waiver.

46 SEVERABILITY

46.1 If any term, condition or provision contained in this Agreement is held to be invalid, unlawful or unenforceable to any extent, such term, condition or provision will not affect the validity, legality or enforceability of the remaining parts of this Agreement.

47 LAW AND JURISDICTION

47.1 This Agreement is governed by the Laws of England and Wales and, subject to Disputes which are properly referred to and resolved in accordance with the Dispute Resolution Procedure, the Parties submit to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts of England and Wales.

48 NOT USED

49 MITIGATION

49.1 The Department and the Employer will at all times take all reasonable steps to minimise and mitigate any loss for which the relevant Party is entitled to bring a claim against the other Party pursuant to this Agreement and to take all reasonable steps to minimise and mitigate any effects or circumstances and/or events adversely affecting the performance of its obligations under this Agreement which would otherwise entitle that Party to relief and/or to claim compensation hereunder.

50 FURTHER ASSURANCE

50.1 Each Party must do all things and execute all further documents necessary to give full effect to this Agreement.

51 THIRD PARTY RIGHTS

51.1 No term of this Agreement is enforceable under the Agreements (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 by a person who is not a party to this Agreement.

52 CONTINUING OBLIGATIONS

52.1 Save as otherwise expressly provided in this Agreement:-

52.1.1 the termination or expiry of this Agreement will be without prejudice to any accrued rights and obligations under this Agreement as at the Expiry Date or the Termination Date; and

52.1.2 the termination or expiry of this Agreement will not affect the continuing rights or obligations of the Department and the Employer under the clauses in the table below and/or under any other provision of this Agreement which is expressed to survive expiry or termination or which is required to give effect to such expiry or termination or the consequences of such expiry of termination for a period of six (6) years, or such time period as set out in the Specifications (Schedule 1) for European Social Fund direct and match funding, after such expiry or termination:

Clause	Description
14	Fraud and Irregularity
15.3	Complaints and Feedback
17	Dispute Resolution
18	Assignment of IPR in Databases
19	Department Data

Clause	Description
20	Data Protection and Protection of Personal Data
23	Freedom of Information and Confidentiality
24	Employees
25	Re-provision of the Services
26	Payment, Funding and Audit
28	Employer's Records and Audit
31	Indemnities and Liability
32	Insurance
36	Consequences of Termination and Expiry
37	Exit Arrangements
43	Public Relations and Publicity
Schedule 6	UK GDPR and Data Protection
Schedule 7	Security & Department Policies
Schedule 8	Exit Arrangements

SCHEDULE 1: SPECIFICATION & MONITORING

ADVANCED LEARNER LOANS SPECIFICATION

Definitions

"Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules"	means the rules that apply to providers of education and training who hold a loans facility and loans bursary Agreement as detailed at Advanced learner loans funding rules 2023 to 2024 - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) The Employer shall note that each amended and updated version of the Advanced Learner Loans funding and performance management rules will form part of this Agreement as if it was the version referred to at the Agreement Date.
"Advanced Learner Loans Provision"	means technical qualifications at levels 3, 4, 5 and 6 in the learning aims section of the Find a Learning Aim Service and the ESFA list of qualifications approved for public funding and the Loans Bursary.
"Funding Claims & Reconciliation Guidance"	means ESFA funding claims and reconciliation - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Loans Bursary"	means funding to help vulnerable and disadvantaged Learners who are being funded through a Loan; up to the value confirmed in Schedule 2, Payments.
"Loans Facility"	gives the Employer the authority to access Loans funding from the SLC, up to the value confirmed in Schedule 2, Payments, and offer Loans funded learning to Learners.
"Loans Prospectus"	means How Awarding Organisations will update the qualifications eligible for loans support. Advanced learner loans: an overview - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Loans Regulations"	means the Further Education Loans Regulations 2012 as detailed at The Further Education Loans Regulations 2012 (legislation.gov.uk)

"Maximum Loan Amount Guidance"	means the maximum loan amounts for designated qualifications as detailed at Maximum loan amounts for advanced learner loans designated qualifications 2023 to 2024 - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Monitoring the Funding Rules"	the document that lists how the Department will monitor the data reported to us by the Employer to provide financial assurance as detailed at Financial assurance: monitoring post-16 funding - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Monitoring Report User Guide"	the document detailing the reports published by the Department and the guidance and process that Employer must follow to comply with the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules Financial assurance: monitoring post-16 funding - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"SLC"	means "Student Loans Company", the organisation that administers Further Education Loans in England.
"SLC Service Agreement"	means The service agreement between the Student Loans Company and the Employer. Service definition and service agreement, Our services | LP Services (slc.co.uk)
"User Guide for the Learning Provider Portal"	means Guidance on the administration of SLC Learning Provider Portal. User guides - Learning Provider Services (slc.co.uk)

Summary of Service

1. Advanced Learner Loans provide a source of fees and support to help people aged 19 and over undertake general and technical qualifications at levels 3, 4, 5 and 6 that will be provided by the Employer.

2. Funding is for the 2023 to 2024 Funding Year, 1st August 2023 to 31st July 2024.

3. The legal basis for this Service is the Teaching & Higher Education Act 1998 and the Further Education Loans Regulations 2012.

4. Failure to comply with this Specification will be a breach of this Agreement. If the Service is terminated, the Department will remove the Employer's eligibility to offer Loans-funded places to Learners.

Service Commencement and Duration

5. Advanced Learner Loans Service Start Date: 29th May 2023.

6. Advanced Learner Loans Expiry Date: 31st October 2024.

Service Requirements

Recruitment

7. The Employer shall recruit eligible Learners onto this service from the Service Start Date until 31st July 2024.

8. The recruitment will comply with the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules, SLC Service Agreement and User Guide for the Learning Provider Portal.

9. The Employer shall aim to maximise the use of the Loans Facility and Loans Bursary fund as set out in Schedule 2, Advanced Learner Loans Payments through its recruitment.

10. The Employer shall not recruit Learners from another contractor that has ceased trading or has had their contract terminated by the Department, without the permission of the Department.

11. Funding for Learners to complete their qualification after the 31st July 2024 will be made available in a subsequent agreement, subject to budget availability.

Outputs

12. The Employer will deliver the Advanced Learner Loans Provision set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules to the requirements set by the Department between 1st August 2023 and 31st July 2024. The Department may update the technical qualifications at levels 3, 4, 5 and 6 in the learning aims section of the Find a Learning Aim Service and the ESFA list of qualifications approved for public funding from time to time as set out in the Loans Prospectus.

13. The Employer will maximise the number of Learners that achieve a qualification. The Department will monitor the achievement rate.

14. The Employer will maintain evidence of the delivery of the Service as set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

15. The Employer will support eligible Learners by using the Loans Bursary to fund hardship, childcare, residential support, and learning support as set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

16. The Employer will support eligible Learners using Exceptional Learning Support where applicable as set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

17. The Employer is responsible to the Learner for the direct delivery of the Provision and will be liable to make any repayment of fees incurred by the Learner to the SLC in the event that;

    a. the Employer fails to deliver the Provision as agreed with the Learner; or

    b. there is evidence that Learners have not been registered for the qualification or registered within Awarding Organisation guidelines; or

    c. there is evidence that the Employer has not followed an Awarding Organisation's policies and procedures.

18. In delivering the Advanced Learner Loans Provision, the Employer will comply with the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

19. In accordance with paragraph 6 of the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules the Employer must not sub-contract Advanced Learner Loans Provision delivery or administration. For the avoidance of doubt Clause 30 Sub-Contracting of the Agreement does not apply for the purposes of Advanced Learner Loans Provision.

20. The Employer must deliver the Advanced Learner Loans Provision in England only.

21. The Employer will deliver the Service in a way that ensures

    a. value for money;

    b. the protection of public funds;

    c. the effective delivery of a high-quality service for Learners appropriate to their needs; and

    d. meets the public benefit test.

<u>Advanced Learner Loans Provision Administration</u>

22. Where the Service is continued from the 2022 to 2023 Funding Year, the Employer must migrate data for continuing Learners from the 2022 to 2023 ILR to the 2023 to 2024 ILR. The Employer must submit this data in the first ILR data return for 2023 to 2024, as set out in Appendix B – Migration Specification of the ILR specification for 2023 to 2024.

23. The Employer will submit Learner Data to the Department to comply with Clause 21, Submission of Learner Data of the Agreement. The data will be accurate and based on evidence or base documentation and align with the data submitted to the SLC by the Employer. Failure to submit records for

less than 95% of Learners and their learning supported by Advanced Learner Loans at any time during the delivery of this Service will be a breach of agreement.

24. The Employer shall complete the Learner's qualification on or before the planned end date in the data submitted in the ILR. Where the Employer misses this date, the Department may consider this a breach of agreement.

25. Where required, the Employer shall submit funding claims in line with Schedule 1B, Advanced Learner Loans Monitoring.

26. The Employer will support the five stages of loans administration as set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

    a. Stage 1 – Issuing the Learning and Funding Information Letter
    b. Stage 2 – The Learner Application
    c. Stage 3 – The Initial Liability Point
    d. Stage 4 – In Learning
    e. Stage 5 – Completion and Achievement

27. The Employer must deliver the Advanced Learner Loans Provision set out in the SLC Service Agreement and the User Guide for the Learning Provider Portal. Failure to meet SLC's service requirements will be a breach of agreement.

28. The Employer must repay any funds paid in error by the SLC including where the Employer has not informed the SLC that a Learner has withdrawn from or changed their qualification. The Employer will repay within 30 days of being requested to do so by the SLC. The Department may recover any payments by offsetting against other Services funded by the Department. Failure to repay the funds will be a breach of agreement.

29. The Employer cannot exceed for any reason the Loans Facility and Loans Bursary contract allocations except by an agreed variation to this Agreement.

30. The Employer must inform the Department of any changes to their bank details. The Employer must not use the new account until the account has been verified by the Department. (Provide information about your banking and payments to DfE - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk))

The Department

31. The Department will set out the maximum amount that can be claimed from the SLC for the delivery of a qualification supported by a loan in the Maximum Loan Amount Guidance.

32. The Department will pay for the Advanced Learner Loans Provision as set out in Schedule 2, Advanced Learner Loan Payments.

33. The Department will pay for Exceptional Learning Support as set out in Schedule 2, Exceptional Learning Support Payments.

34. The Department will supply the Employer's verified bank details to the SLC to enable the SLC to pay for the delivery of the loans supported qualifications.

35. The Department will monitor the Advanced Learner Loans Provision as set out in Schedule 1B, Advanced Learner Loans Monitoring.

SCHEDULE 1B: MONITORING

ADVANCED LEARNER LOANS MONITORING (PAY ON PROFILE)

Monitoring of ILR Submission

1. The Department will monitor and review the data submitted under Clause 21, Submission of Learner Data of this Agreement to ensure that payments are made in accordance with the requirements set out in "Financial Assurance: Monitoring post-16 funding for 2023 to 2024" at Financial assurance: monitoring post-16 funding - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk).

2. The Department will publish monitoring reports on View your education data. The Employer must access the monitoring reports every month and amend any errors for the next submission by taking the actions specified in the report user guide. Failure to amend the data as required will constitute a breach of agreement in accordance with Clause 34 of the Agreement.

3. If served with notice of a breach, the Employer must correct data or supply the Department with evidence within the period specified in the notice. This evidence can include digital copies of documents such as Learner files, commitment statements or employer declarations. Annotated spreadsheets or notes are not acceptable as evidence.

4. Where data is incorrect in the final data submission of the academic year the Department will recover the payments associated with the incorrect data.

Monitoring of SLC Data Submission

5. The Employer's submission of data to the SLC will be monitored against the service levels set out in the Employer's SLC Service Agreement. The Employer must take any corrective action to correct submissions or service levels when requested to do so by the SLC.

Loans Facility and Loans Bursary Performance Management

6. The Department will review the performance of the Services as set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules. Where the performance of the Service is below the published tolerances and thresholds, the Department will reduce the contract allocation in line with the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

7. At the performance management points set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules, the Department may invite Employers to submit requests for increases to its Funding. The Department will award growth in-line with the criteria set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

Loans Facility Monitoring

8. It is not permitted to vire the Funding between the Loans Bursary and Loans Facility without an agreed variation in writing to this Agreement (in accordance with Clause 44, Amendments to this Agreement, of the Agreement).

9. The Loans Facility cannot be exceeded for any reason except by an agreed variation in writing to this Agreement.

10. The Department will instruct the SLC to stop approving new Loans Facility applications and/or to stop making Loans Facility payments to the Employer, and/or reclaim any Loans Facility payments made, where the Employer exceeds its Loans Facility without agreement, breaches the Agreement or goes into administration or liquidation.

Loans Bursary Reconciliation

11. The Department will reconcile the Employer's earnings against the payments made. The reconciliation will be to the timetable set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules and will follow the process in the Funding Claims & Reconciliation Guidance. The Department will calculate the earnings using the formula set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules.

12. Failure to submit an in-year forecast or final claim to the published timescales will constitute a breach of agreement and any reconciliation will be at the Department's discretion.

13. Where the Employer's actual delivery in the final claim, as against the contract allocation, will result or has already resulted in an overpayment by the Department to the Employer, the Department will deduct the amount owed over the remainder of the Financial Year as defined in Clause 26.1.5 and may offset the overpayment against other payments being made to the Employer. Where the overpayment cannot be recovered from future payments within the Financial Year, the Department will invoice the Employer for the remaining debt and the Employer will pay the invoice within 30 days.

14. Where the Employer's actual delivery in the final claim, has exceeded the contract allocation, the Employer does so at their own risk. The Department may pay for the over-delivery, subject to budget availability and funding policy at the time.

15. Should there be an under or over payment to the Employer, the Department will consider the underlying causes for that, in accordance with the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules and, may at its absolute discretion require a variation to amend the contract allocation in the current or future years.

16. Where either the in-year forecast (based at the mid-year funding claim), amount of Loans Bursary spend, or the final outturn of Loans Bursary Funding used from the prior year, is below 75% of the contract allocation, the Department, will review the Loans Bursary allocation, and will, at its own discretion, reduce the contract allocation in the Agreement down in line with the in-year forecast or prior year outturn.

17. For the purposes of this process, the mid-year claim reconciliation constitutes a debt for the purposes of Clause 26.1.5 of the Agreement.

SCHEDULE 2: PAYMENT

ADVANCED LEARNER LOANS PAYMENT (PAY ON PROFILE)

Advanced Learner Loans Facility

1. The Loans Facility will be paid by the SLC as set out in the SLC Service Agreement. The Department will not pay for the Loans Facility.

2. The Employer's Loans Facility is set out in the Funding Agreement of this Schedule.

Advanced Learner Loans Bursary

3. The Department will pay the Employer the Funding set out in the Funding Agreement of this Schedule on or before the 20th of the month.

4. Under Item 5A to Group 6 of Schedule 9 of the VAT Act 1994, the supply of education or vocational training funded by the Department and the supply by the person providing that education or vocational training, of any goods or services essential to that provision, is considered to be an exempt supply for VAT purposes. The Department is generally unable to recover any Value Added Tax charged. The maximum sum payable as Funding under this Agreement, as set out in the Funding Agreement of this Schedule is inclusive of all of the costs of the service including, but not limited to, any other VAT or taxes to be charged, where they apply.

Adult Exceptional Learning Support

5. The Employer must submit a planned claim for Exceptional Learning Support at the start of the Funding Year in line with the process and eligibility set out in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules. The Employer must not incur costs until the planned claim for support has been approved by the Department.

6. The Department will only fund planned claims agreed before the end of the Funding Year, 31st July 2024.

7. The Department will only pay final claims that meet the eligibility requirements in the Advanced Learner Loans Funding and performance management Rules and are received by the Department before the claim deadline of October 2024 (refer to the latest version of How to Submit a Funding Claim for the final submission date).

8. The Department will pay final claims in December 2024.

Funding Agreement

9. The following Funding Agreement sets out the funding available for this Service.

ADVANCED LEARNER LOANS

Funding Agreement – Advanced Learner Loans Facility

Provider: 10017220 Co Ltd **UKPRN:** 10017220

Master Contract Number: ESFA-196002 **Start Date:** 01/08/2023 **End Date:** 31/07/2024

Contract Ref: ALLF-45522

	Cash (£)	Aug 2023	Sep 2023	Oct 2023	Nov 2023	Dec 2023	Jan 2024	Feb 2024	Mar 2024	Apr 2024	May 2024	Jun 2024	Jul 2024
Advanced Learner Loans Facility	£30,000	£3,920	£1,841	£3,077	£1,133	£1,859	£5,703	£3,330	£2,338	£1,523	£1,130	£2,147	£1,999
Total Funding	£30,000	£3,920	£1,841	£3,077	£1,133	£1,859	£5,703	£3,330	£2,338	£1,523	£1,130	£2,147	£1,999

ADVANCED LEARNER LOANS

Funding Agreement – Advanced Learner Loans Bursary

Provider: 10017220 Co Ltd **UKPRN:** 10017220

Master Contract Number: ESFA-196002 **Start Date:** 01/08/2023 **End Date:** 31/07/2024

Contract Ref: ALLB-13263

	Cash (£)	Aug 2023	Sep 2023	Oct 2023	Nov 2023	Dec 2023	Jan 2024	Feb 2024	Mar 2024	Apr 2024	May 2024	Jun 2024	Jul 2024
Advanced Learner Loans Bursary Funding	£40,000	£2,479	£2,327	£3,870	£2,394	£982	£3,105	£4,687	£2,054	£2,077	£7,999	£5,908	£2,118
Total Funding	£40,000	£2,479	£2,327	£3,870	£2,394	£982	£3,105	£4,687	£2,054	£2,077	£7,999	£5,908	£2,118

Ref (for internal use only): EDSK-62743 v1
Date: Thursday, March 30, 2023 10:30 AM

SCHEDULE 3: NOT USED

SCHEDULE 4: NOT USED

SCHEDULE 5: NOT USED

SCHEDULE 6: UK GDPR AND DATA PROTECTION

PROCESSING, PERSONAL DATA AND DATA SUBJECTS

Description	Details
Subject matter of the Processing	The subject matter is the Personal Data of Learners on education or training programmes administered by the Department that are subject to this Agreement as defined in the Department Personal Information Charter, the privacy notice for Key Stage 5 and adult education and the ILR privacy notice and documentation. Personal information charter - Department for Education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) Privacy notice for Key Stage 5 and adult education - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) ILR privacy notice and documentation (link to be provided in subsequent variation)
Duration of the Processing	The duration of the Processing covers the Agreement Period.
Nature and purposes of the Processing	The Employer will be required to submit the data to the Department for the purposes as set out in Clause 21 (Submission of Learner Data) of this Agreement. The processing of data in the Agreement refers to the submission of ILR data to the Department only. The processing does not include the processing of Personal Data collected from the Learners by the body for the purposes of enrolling Learners onto programmes or delivering education or training.
Type of personal data	The Personal Data to be processed is defined in the ILR specification: Individualised Learner Record (ILR) technical documents, guidance and requirements (submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk)
Categories of data subject	The data subjects are Learners on education or training programmes administered by the Department that are subject to this Agreement.

Description	Details
Plan for return and destruction of the data once the processing is complete UNLESS requirement under Union or Member State law to preserve that type of data	The Employer is required to retain ILR data for 3 years for business operational purposes. For the purposes of the Department as a Data Controller of the data, the Employer is required to retain the Learner Records data for the funding and audit purposes set out in this Agreement for six (6) years from the end of the Financial Year in which the last payment is made under this Agreement. For the purposes of the Department for Work & Pensions as a Data Controller, where Learner Records data is used as match on the 2014-20 ESF programme, the data must be retained securely until 31st December 2034. The Employer (and any other Data Controller) is responsible for determining any further need to process the data, including its retention, prior to secure destruction. The Employer shall comply with Clause 36 (Consequences of Termination and Expiry) which sets out provisions that will apply to Learner Records after this Agreement has been terminated or has expired.

SCHEDULE 7: SECURITY & DEPARTMENT POLICIES

Part A: Security

"ACSC" "Assured Cyber Security Consultancy"	is the National Cyber Security Centre's (NCSC) approach to assessing the services provided by consultancies and confirming that they meet NCSC's standards. See website: Assured Cyber Security Consultancy - NCSC.GOV.UK
"BPSS" "Baseline Personnel Security Standard"	the Government's HMG Baseline Personal Security Standard. Further information can be found at: Government baseline personnel security standard - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"CCP" "Certified Cyber Professional"	is a NCSC scheme in consultation with government, industry and academia to address the growing need for specialists in the cyber security profession. See website: Certified Cyber Professional (CCP) assured service - NCSC.GOV.UK
"CPA" "Commercial Product Assurance" [formerly called "CESG Product Assurance"]	is an 'information assurance scheme' which evaluates commercial off the shelf (COTS) products and their developers against published security and development standards. See website: Commercial Product Assurance (CPA) - NCSC.GOV.UK
"Cyber Essentials" "Cyber Essentials Plus"	Cyber Essentials is the government backed, industry supported scheme to help organisations protect themselves against common cyber-attacks. Cyber Essentials and Cyber Essentials Plus are levels within the scheme. There are a number of certification bodies that can be approached for further advice on the scheme; the link below points to these providers: IASME Cyber Assurance Level 1 (Verified Assessment) - Iasme
"Department Data" "Department's Information"	as defined in Clause 1 (Definitions) of the Agreement.
"Department"	as defined in Clause 1 (Definitions) of the Agreement.

“Departmental Security Standards”	means the Department’s security policy or any standards, procedures, process or specification for security that the Employer is required to deliver.
“Digital Marketplace / GCloud”	means the online framework for identifying and procuring cloud technology and people for digital projects.
“End User Devices”	the personal computer or consumer devices that store or process information.
“Good Industry Practice”	as defined in Clause 1 (Definitions) of the Agreement.
“Good Industry Standard”	means the implementation of products and solutions, and the exercise of that degree of skill, care, prudence, efficiency, foresight and timeliness as would be expected from a leading company within the relevant industry or business sector.
“GSC” “GSCP” “Government Security Classifications Policy”	means the Government Security Classification Policy which establishes the rules for classifying HMG information. The policy is available at: Government Security Classifications - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
“HMG”	means His Majesty’s Government.
“ICT”	means Information and Communications Technology (ICT) is used as an extended synonym for information technology (IT), used to describe the bringing together of enabling technologies used to deliver the end-to-end solution.
“ISO/IEC 27001” “ISO 27001”	is the International Standard for Information Security Management Systems Requirements.
“ISO/IEC 27002” “ISO 27002”	is the International Standard describing the Code of Practice for Information Security Controls.
“ISO 22301”	is the International Standard describing for Business Continuity.
“IT Security Health Check (ITSHC)” “IT Health Check (ITHC)” “Penetration Testing”	means an assessment to identify risks and vulnerabilities in systems, applications and networks which may compromise the confidentiality, integrity or availability of information held on that IT system.
“Need-to-Know”	the Need-to-Know principle is employed within HMG to limit the distribution of classified information to those people with a clear ‘need to

	know' in order to carry out their duties.
"NCSC"	The National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) formerly CESG is the UK government's National Technical Authority for Information Assurance. The NCSC website is National Cyber Security Centre - NCSC.GOV.UK
"OFFICIAL" "OFFICIAL-SENSITIVE"	the term 'OFFICIAL' is used to describe the baseline level of 'security classification' described within the Government Security Classification Policy (GSCP). the term 'OFFICIAL–SENSITIVE' is used to identify a limited subset of OFFICIAL information that could have more damaging consequences (for individuals, an organisation or government generally) if it were lost, stolen or published in the media, as described in the GSCP.
"RBAC" "Role Based Access Control"	means Role Based Access Control. A method of restricting a person's or process' access to information depending on the role or functions assigned to them.
"Secure Sanitisation"	means the process of treating data held on storage media to reduce the likelihood of retrieval and reconstruction to an acceptable level. NCSC Guidance can be found at: Secure sanitisation of storage media - NCSC.GOV.UK The disposal of physical documents and hardcopy materials advice can be found at: Secure Destruction | CPNI
"Security and Information Risk Advisor" "CCP SIRA" "SIRA"	means the Security and Information Risk Advisor (SIRA) is a role defined under the NCSC Certified Cyber Professional (CCP) Scheme. See also: Certified Cyber Professional (CCP) assured service - NCSC.GOV.UK
"Senior Information Risk Owner" "SIRO"	means the Senior Information Risk Owner (SIRO) responsible on behalf of the DfE Accounting Officer for overseeing the management of information risk across the organisation. This includes its executive agencies, arm's length bodies (ALBs), non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) and devolved information held by third parties.

"SPF" "HMG Security Policy Framework"	means the definitive HMG Security Policy which describes the expectations of the Cabinet Secretary and Government's Official Committee on Security on how HMG organisations and third parties handling HMG information and other assets will apply protective security to ensure HMG can function effectively, efficiently and securely. Security policy framework: protecting government assets - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)
"Storage Area Network" "SAN"	means an information storage system typically presenting block based storage (i.e. disks or virtual disks) over a network interface rather than using physically connected storage.

1.1. The Employer will be aware of and comply with the relevant HMG security policy framework, NCSC guidelines and where applicable Security and Departmental policies which include but are not constrained to the following paragraphs.

1.2. In the collection and processing of the data set out in Schedule 6, UK GDPR and Data Protection, the requirements of Cabinet Office Procurement Policy Note 09/14: Cyber Essentials scheme certification - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk) dated 25 May 2016, or any subsequent updated document, are mandated, and the Employer will work towards meeting the requirements of Cyber Essentials during the 2023/24 Funding Year and present the evidence to the Department on request. The scope must be relevant to the submission of data to the Department, including an allowance for a sub-set scope if appropriate.

1.3. The Employer will follow the Cabinet Office guidance on Government Security Classifications (GSCP) in respect of any Department Data being handled in the course of providing this Service, and will handle this data in accordance with its security classification. (In the event where the Employer has an existing Protective Marking Scheme then the Employer may continue to use this but must map the HMG security classifications against it to ensure the correct controls are applied to the Department Data).

1.4. The Employer will have in place and maintain physical security to premises and sensitive areas in line with those outlined in ISO/IEC 27002 including, but not limited to, entry control mechanisms (e.g. door access), CCTV, alarm systems, etc.

1.5. The Employer will have in place and maintain an appropriate user access control policy for all ICT systems to ensure only authorised personnel have access to Departmental Data. This policy should include appropriate segregation of duties and if applicable Role Based Access Controls (RBAC). User credentials that give access to Departmental Data or systems shall be considered to be sensitive data and must be protected accordingly.

1.6. The Employer will have in place and will maintain procedural, personnel, physical and technical safeguards to protect Department Data, including but not limited to:

(a) physical security controls;

(b) Good Industry Standard policies and processes;

(c) malware protection;

(d) boundary access controls including firewalls, application gateways, etc;

(e) maintenance and use of fully supported software packages in accordance with vendor recommendations;

(f) use of secure device configuration and builds;

(g) software updates and patching regimes including malware signatures, for operating systems, network devices, applications and services;

(h) user identity and access controls, including the use of multi-factor authentication for sensitive data and privileged account accesses;

(i) any services provided to the Department must capture audit logs for security events in an electronic format at the application, service and system level to meet the Department's logging and auditing requirements, plus logs shall be:

(i) retained and protected from tampering for a minimum period of six months; and

(ii) made available to the Department on request.

1.7. The Employer will ensure that any Department Data (including email) transmitted over any public network (including the Internet, mobile networks, or un-protected enterprise network) or to a mobile device shall be encrypted when transmitted.

1.8. The Employer will ensure that any Department Data which resides on a mobile, removable or physically uncontrolled device is stored encrypted using a product or system component which has been formally assured through a recognised certification process agreed with the Department except where the department has given its prior written consent to an alternative arrangement.

1.9. The Employer will ensure that any device which is used to process Department Data meets all of the security requirements set out in the NCSC End User Devices Platform Security Guidance, a copy of which can be found at: Device Security Guidance - NCSC.GOV.UK and Device security principles for manufacturers (beta release) - NCSC.GOV.UK.

1.10. Whilst in the Employer's care all removable media and hardcopy paper documents containing Department Data must be handled securely and secured under lock and key when not in use and shall be securely destroyed when no longer required, using either a cross-cut shredder or a professional secure disposal organisation. The term 'lock and key' is defined as: "securing information in a lockable desk drawer, cupboard or filing cabinet which is under the user's sole control and to which they hold the keys".

1.11. When necessary to hand carry removable media and/or hardcopy paper documents containing Department Data, the media or documents being carried shall be kept under cover and transported in such a way as to ensure that no unauthorised person has either visual or physical access to the material being carried. This Paragraph 1.11 will apply equally regardless of whether the material is being carried inside or outside of company premises. The term 'under cover' means that the information is carried within an opaque folder or envelope within official premises and buildings and within a closed briefcase or other similar bag or container when outside official premises or buildings.

1.12. In the event of termination, equipment failure or obsolescence, all Department Data, in either hardcopy or electronic format, that is physically held or logically stored by the Employer must be accounted for and either physically returned or securely sanitised or destroyed in accordance with the current HMG policy using an NCSC approved product or method. Where sanitisation or destruction is not possible for legal, regulatory or technical reasons, such as data stored in a cloud system, Storage Area Network (SAN) or on shared backup tapes, then the Employer or Sub-Contractor will protect the Department's information and data until such time, which may be long after the end of the Agreement, when it can be securely cleansed or destroyed. Evidence of secure destruction will be required in all cases.

1.13. Access by Employer or Sub-Contractor staff to Department Data, including user credentials, shall be confined to those individuals who have a "Need-to-Know" in order to carry out their role; and have undergone mandatory pre-employment screening, to a minimum of HMG Baseline Personnel Security Standard (BPSS); or hold an appropriate National Security Vetting clearance as required by the Department. All Employer or Sub-Contractor staff must complete this process before access to Department Data is permitted. Any Employer or Sub-Contractor staff who will be in contact with children or vulnerable adults must, in addition to any security clearance, have successfully undergone an Enhanced DBS (Disclosure and Barring Service) check prior to any contact.

1.14. All Employer or Sub-Contractor employees who handle Department Data must have annual awareness training in protecting information.

1.15. Notwithstanding any other provisions as to business continuity and disaster recovery in the Agreement, the Employer will, as a minimum, have in place robust Business Continuity arrangements and processes including IT disaster recovery plans and procedures that conform to ISO 22301 to ensure that the delivery of the Agreement is not adversely affected in the event of an incident. An incident will be defined as any situation that might, or could lead to, a disruption, loss, emergency or crisis to the Services delivered. If an ISO 22301 certificate is not available, the Employer will provide evidence of the effectiveness of their ISO 22301 conformant Business Continuity arrangements and processes including IT disaster recovery plans and procedures. This should include evidence that the Employer has tested or exercised these plans within the last twelve (12) months and produced a written report of the outcome, including required actions.

1.16. Any suspected or actual breach of the confidentiality, integrity or availability of Department Data, including user credentials, used or handled in the course of providing this service shall be recorded as an incident. This includes any non-compliance with these Departmental Security Standards for Employers, or other Security Standards pertaining to the solution. Incidents shall be reported to the department immediately, wherever practical, even if unconfirmed or when full details are not known, but always within 24 hours of discovery. If incident reporting has been delayed by more than 24 hours, the Employer should provide an explanation about the delay. The Employer will inform their Agreement Manager in writing. Incidents will be investigated by the Employer with outcomes being notified to the Department.

1.17. The Employer will ensure that any IT systems and hosting environments that are used to handle, store or process Department Data will be subject to independent IT Health Checks (ITHC) using a NCSC approved ITHC provider before go-live and periodically (at least annually) thereafter. The findings of the ITHC relevant to the Service being provided are to be shared with the Department and all necessary remedial work carried out. In the event of significant security issues being identified, a follow up remediation test may be required.

1.18. The Employer or Sub-Contractors providing the service will provide the Department with full details of any actual or future intent to develop, manage, support, process or store Department Data outside of the UK mainland. The Employer or Sub-Contractor will not go ahead with any such proposal without the prior written agreement from the Department.

1.19. The Department reserves the right to audit the Employer or Sub-Contractors providing the Service within a mutually agreed timeframe but always within seven (7) days of notice of a request to audit being given. The audit will cover the overall scope of the Service being supplied and the Employer's, and any Sub-Contractors, compliance with this Schedule 7 (Security and Department Policies).

1.20. The Employer and Sub-Contractors will undergo appropriate security assurance activities and will provide appropriate evidence including the production of the necessary security documentation as determined by the Department. This will include obtaining any necessary professional security resources required to support the Employer's and Sub-Contractor's security assurance activities such as: a Security and Information Risk Advisor (SIRA) certified to NCSC Assured Cyber Security Consultancy (ACSC) or NCSC Certified Cyber Professional.

1.21. The Employer will contractually enforce all this Schedule 7 (Security and Department Policies) onto any third-party suppliers, Sub-Contractors or partners who could potentially access Department Data in the course of providing this Service.

Part B: Department Policies

The following code outlines the standards and behaviors expected from suppliers and grant recipients, and reiterate the government's approach to working with suppliers.

Codes of conduct for suppliers and grant recipients - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk)

SCHEDULE 8: EXIT ARRANGEMENTS

1 DEFINITIONS

"Exit Manager"	the person appointed by each Party pursuant to Paragraph 3.3 of this Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements) for managing the Employer's obligations under Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements);
"Exit Plan"	the plan produced and updated by the Employer during the Agreement Period in accordance with Paragraph 5 of this Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements);

2 OVERVIEW

2.1 The Employer is required to ensure it performs its obligations to assist in the orderly transition of the Services from the Employer to the Department and/or any Successor Employer in the event of termination (including partial termination) or expiry of this Agreement. This will include the transition of the Services to a follow-on agreement with the same Employer if applicable. This Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements) sets out the principles of the exit and service transfer arrangements that are intended to achieve such orderly transition. For the avoidance of doubt, the Employer will be responsible for the overall management of the exit and service transfer arrangements.

3 CONTRACT LIFE OBLIGATIONS

3.1 The Employer will draw up an Exit Plan in accordance with Paragraph 5.1.

3.2 The Employer will (unless otherwise agreed by the Department in writing) procure that all Sub-Contracts and other agreements with third parties used exclusively to deliver the Services to the Department, which are necessary to enable the Department and/or any Successor Employer to perform the Services in accordance with this Agreement or to enable re-provision of the Services, will be assignable and/or capable of novation at the request of the Department to the Department (and/or its nominee) and/or any Successor Employer upon the Employer ceasing to provide the Services (or part of them) without restriction (including any need to obtain any consent or approval) or payment by the Department. Where the Employer uses Sub-Contracts and other agreements to deliver the Services and these agreements are part of framework agreements that the Employer has with its third party suppliers, the Employer will provide sufficient information and assistance to enable the Successor Employer or the Department to enter into an agreement with such supplier directly.

3.3 The Employer will appoint an Exit Manager. The Employer's Exit Manager will be responsible for ensuring that the Employer and its personnel, agents and Sub-Contractors comply with this Schedule 8 (Exit

Arrangements). The Employer will ensure that its Exit Manager has the requisite authority to arrange and procure any resources of the Employer as are reasonably necessary to enable the Employer to comply with the requirements set out in this Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements).

4 OBLIGATIONS TO ASSIST ON RE-PROVISION OF SERVICES OR TRANSFER BACK TO THE DEPARTMENT

4.1 On reasonable notice, the Employer will on request provide to the Department and/or to its potential Successor Employer, the following material and information in order to facilitate the preparation by the Department of any invitation to tender and/or to facilitate any potential Successor Employer undertaking due diligence:

4.1.1 details of the Services;

4.1.2 an inventory of Department Data (including but not limited to e-portfolios and any other Learner Files) in the Employer's possession or control; and

4.1.3 all information relating to Transferring Employees required to be provided by the Employer under this Agreement.

5 EXIT PLAN

5.1 The Employer will within three (3) months after the Services Start Date maintain an Exit Plan which sets out the Employer's proposed methodology for achieving an orderly transition of Services from the Employer to the Department and/or its Successor Employer on the expiry or termination of this Agreement and which complies with the requirements set out in Paragraphs 5.2 and 5.3 below.

5.2 The Exit Plan will:

5.2.1 document how the Services will transfer to the Successor Employer (which will need to be agreed between the Employer and the Successor Employer) and/or the Department, including details of the processes to transfer documentation, Department Data (including e-portfolios and other Learner records), systems migration, security and the segregation of the Department’s technology components from any technology components operated by the Employer or its Sub-Contractors (where applicable);

5.2.2 set out procedures to deal with requests made by the Department and/or a Successor Employer for staffing information pursuant to Clause 25 of the Agreement (Re-Provision of the Services);

5.2.3 address each of the issues set out in this Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements) to facilitate the transition of the Services from the Employer to the Successor Employer and/or the Department with the aim of ensuring that there is no disruption to or degradation of the Services;

5.2.4 list software agreements and licence agreements required to deliver the Services.

5.3 The Employer will review and (if appropriate) update the Exit Plan each year to reflect changes in the Services.

6 TERMINATION OBLIGATIONS

6.1 In addition to the obligations as set out in Clauses 35 (Termination) and 36 (Consequences of Termination and Expiry) of the Agreement, the Employer will comply with all of its obligations contained in the Exit Plan.

6.2 Within six (6) months of the Expiry Date (except where the Service will be rolled over to the following Funding Year) or Termination Date:

6.2.1 the Employer will, subject to the requirement to retain one copy for the purpose of compliance with Clause 52 (Continuing Obligations) and the retention requirements of this Agreement, erase from any computers, storage devices and storage media that are to be retained by the Employer, all Department Data;

6.2.2 the Employer will return or make available for the Successor Employer or the Department to use such of the following as is in the Employer's possession or control:

6.2.2.1 all materials created by the Employer under this Agreement, the IPRs in which are owned by the Department;

6.2.2.2 details of work volumes and staffing requirements over the twelve (12) month period immediately prior;

6.2.3 the Employer will:

6.2.3.1 with respect to learning or training in progress, document the current status and stabilising for continuity during transition;

6.2.3.2 provide assistance and expertise as necessary to examine all governance and reports in place for the provision of the Services;

6.2.3.3 answer all reasonable questions from the Department and/or its Successor Employer regarding the Services;

6.2.3.4 agree with the Department and/or the Successor Employer a plan for the migration of the Department Data to the Department and/or the Successor Employer. The Employer will fully co-operate in the execution of the agreed plan, providing skills and expertise of a reasonably acceptable standard; and

6.2.4 each Party will return to the other Party all Confidential Information of the other Party and will certify that it does not retain the other Party's Confidential Information save to the extent (and for the limited period) that such information needs to be retained

by the Party in question for the purposes of providing or receiving any Services.

6.3 Except where this Agreement provides otherwise, all licences, leases and authorisations granted by one Party to the other in relation to the Services will be terminated with effect from the Expiry Date or Termination Date.

7 KNOWLEDGE TRANSFER

7.1 Three (3) months prior to the Expiry Date of the Agreement (or where the Agreement is terminated within the timescale notified by the Department) the Employer will upon request:

7.1.1 provide for transfer to the Department and/or the Successor Employer of all knowledge reasonably required for the provision of the Services which may, as appropriate, include information, records and documents including that relating to configuration of software; and

7.1.2 provide the Department and/or Successor Employer with reasonable access to such members of the Employer's or its Sub-Contractors' personnel as have been involved in the development, provision or management of the Services and who are still employed or engaged by the Employer or its Sub-Contractors.

7.2 To facilitate the transfer of knowledge from the Employer to the Department and/or its Successor Employer, the Employer will provide, upon request, a detailed written explanation of the procedures and operations used to provide the Services, the change management process and other standards and procedures to the operations personnel of the Department and/or the Successor Employer.

7.3 The information which the Employer will provide, at its own cost, to the Department and/or its Successor Employer pursuant to Paragraph 7.1 above will include:

7.3.1 copies of up-to-date procedures and manuals;

7.3.2 agreements with third party suppliers of goods and services which are to be transferred to the Department/Successor Employer;

7.3.3 key support contact details for third party supplier personnel under Agreements which are to be assigned or novated to the Department/Successor Employer pursuant to this Schedule 8 (Exit Arrangements);

7.3.4 any relevant interface information.

8 ASSETS, SUB-CONTRACTS AND SOFTWARE

8.1 Following notice of termination of this Agreement, the Employer will not, without the Department’s prior written consent:

8.1.1 enter into or vary any Sub-Contract;

8.1.2 enter into or vary any licence for software in connection with the Services.

9 EMPLOYER PERSONNEL

9.1 The Department and Employer agree and acknowledge that in the event of the Employer ceasing to provide the Services or part of them for any reason, Clause 25 of the Agreement (Re-Provision of the Services) will apply.

10 PAYMENT

10.1 The provisions of Clause 36 (Consequences of Termination and Expiry) of the Agreement apply.

SCHEDULE 9: SUB-CONTRACTING

General

1.1. The Employer must comply with;

1.1.1. the Funding Rules; and

1.1.2. the Sub-Contractor Policies; and

1.1.3. the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules; and

1.1.4. the Funding Higher Risk Organisations and Subcontractors Policy (hereafter referred to as the **"Funding Higher Risk Organisations Policy"**).

1.2. The Employer must select its Sub-Contractors fairly and without discrimination and must comply with any procurement rules that apply when doing so, including the Public Contracts Regulations 2015 where the Employer is a contracting authority under those regulations.

1.3. The Employer must ensure that proposed Sub-Contractors are of adequate financial standing and have sufficient capacity and capability to deliver the Services that are to be sub-contracted.

1.4. When appointing and working with Sub-Contractors the Employer must have regard to "Selection and procurement of your subcontractors" of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules in relation to conflicts of interest.

1.5. The Employer must have a direct contractual relationship by way of a Sub-Contract with all of its Sub-Contractors. The Employer must ensure that its Sub-Contractors do not sub-contract any of the Services further to other suppliers.

1.6. The Employer must not enter into any agreement for Brokerage in relation to the Services under this Agreement.

Requirements for Sub-Contracts

1.7. The Employer must enter into a written Sub-Contract with any supplier that the Employer is proposing to use as a Sub-Contractor. The Employer and the Sub-Contractor must enter into the Sub-Contract before the Sub-Contractor commences the delivery of the proposed sub-contracted Services.

1.8. The Sub-Contract must include:

1.8.1. terms and conditions substantially the same as those set out in this Agreement, including but not limited to the right for the Employer to terminate the Sub-Contract if the Sub-Contractor does not pass the annual due diligence checks and such other matters as are set out in "Due diligence requirements" of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules;

1.8.2. payment provisions such that the Employer must pay the Sub-Contractor within 30 days of receiving a valid invoice;

1.8.3. an obligation on the Sub-Contractor to obtain express written permission from the Employer before enrolling any Learners;

1.8.4. an obligation on the Sub-Contractor to fund and support enrolled Learners for the duration of their Learning Programme;

1.8.5. an obligation on the Sub-Contractor to participate in any rectification plan as appropriate in the event that the Sub-Contractor has committed an act which would constitute a material breach of this Agreement (whether or not it is also a breach of the Sub-Contract); and

1.8.6. sanctions on the Sub-Contractor for material breach of the Sub-Contract substantially the same as those set out in this Agreement.

1.9. Sub-Contracts must be available at all times for the Department to inspect on request.

Employer Obligations

1.10. The Employer must make payment to any Sub-Contractor within 30 days of receiving a valid invoice in accordance with the required provisions of the Sub-Contract set out at Paragraph 1.8.2 of this Schedule.

1.11. The Employer must provide a fully completed Sub-Contractor Declaration via Manage your Education and Skills Funding (MYESF) on at least two occasions per Funding Year by the dates notified to it by the Department. If the Employer does not have any Sub-Contractors at the specified date it must submit a nil return. If after submission of its most recent Sub-Contractor declaration the Employer enters into any Sub-Contract within the Funding Year, it must submit an updated Sub-Contractor Declaration to the Department.

1.12. The Employer must publish a policy statement on its public facing website by 31 October in each Funding Year. The policy statement must accord with the provisions of ”Your policies for subcontracting and fees and charges” of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules.

1.13. The Employer must manage and monitor its Sub-Contractors in accordance with the relevant Sub-Contract to ensure that the Sub-Contractors deliver the sub-contracted Services to the standard set out in Clause 3 (Service Delivery) of this Agreement.

1.14. The Employer must inform the Department whenever a Sub-Contractor goes into administration or liquidation.

1.15. The Employer must have a contingency plan in place to ensure that there is continuity of Services for existing Learners in the event of any circumstances that may arise that render a Sub-Contractor unable to deliver the sub-contracted Services including but not limited to the expiry or termination of the Sub-Contract.

1.16. The Employer must ensure that a Sub-Contractor that has committed an act which constitutes a material breach of this Agreement (whether or

not it is also a breach of its Sub-Contract) participates in any rectification plan as appropriate.

1.17. The Employer must carry out an investigation at its own cost if there is any evidence of a Sub-Contractor having irregular financial or delivery activity and notify the Department of this and of the outcome of any such investigation.

1.18. The Employer must not enter new Sub-Contracting arrangements or increase the value of existing arrangements if any of the following circumstances apply:

1.18.1. Ofsted has rated the Employer's management and leadership as inadequate;

1.18.2. the outcome of the Employer's annual financial health assessment is inadequate, unless the Department has provided its written consent to the proposed Sub-Contracting arrangement in advance of a Sub-Contract being entered into;

1.18.3. a Sub-Contractor has been inspected and judged to be inadequate by Ofsted; or

1.18.4. a Sub-Contractor is subject to ongoing intervention or investigation by the Department.

Due Diligence

1.19. The Employer must carry out its own due diligence checks when appointing Sub-Contractors and must take account of the criteria set out in the **Funding Higher Risk Organisations Policy.**

1.20. The Employer must ensure it refreshes the due diligence checks on its Sub-Contracting arrangements on at least an annual basis, including but not limited to reviewing its Sub-Contracts and the rationale for entering into each Sub-Contract, any fees and charges involved in the delivery of its sub-contracted Services and whether each cost is reasonable and proportionate in accordance with ”Due diligence requirements” of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules.

1.21. If a Sub-Contractor does not pass the due diligence requirements set out at ”Due diligence requirements” of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules, the Employer must take action in accordance with ”Due diligence requirements” of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules.

Sub-Contracting Thresholds

1.22. The Employer must continuously review the size of its sub-contracted Services and ensure this does not exceed 25%.

1.23. The Employer must promptly submit a request for an exemption if it anticipates that its Sub-Contracting will exceed 25% (“**Exemption Case**”). The Employer must submit such Exemption Case no less than twelve (12) weeks prior to exceeding the threshold. The Department may consider Exemption Cases that are submitted later if the Employer provides evidence of exceptional circumstances. The Department reserves the right to decline the Employer’s Exemption Case.

1.24. If the Employer has previously submitted an Exemption Case, it should continue to seek permission to exceed the threshold set out in Paragraph 1.23 above and must submit an Exemption Case to the Department by no later than 11.59pm on 31 March in each Funding Year. The Department will only consider late requests where there is evidence of exceptional circumstances. The Department may consider Exemption Cases that are submitted later if the Employer provides evidence of exceptional circumstances. The Department reserves the right to decline the Employer's Exemption Case.

1.25. The Exemption Case and the Employer's submission of it must comply with "Subcontracting threshold and exemption cases" of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules.

1.26. The Department will consider any submitted Exemption Case in accordance with the provisions of "Subcontracting threshold and exemption cases" of the Sub-Contracting Funding Rules and will notify the Employer as to whether or not the Exemption Case is accepted.

1.27. The Department expects that any fee retained by the Employer as a management fee for a Sub-Contract will not exceed 20% of the overall value of the Sub-Contract. In the event that the management fee is in excess of 20% of the overall value of the Sub-Contract the Department reserves the right to require the Employer to provide further information in relation to the rationale for the management fee and why it represents good value for money.

Financial Thresholds

1.28. Where the annual value in any Funding Year of this Agreement exceeds £5 million and the Employer wants to sub-contract one or more of the Services the following provisions apply:

1.28.1. The Employer will advertise on Contracts Finder all sub-contract opportunities arising from or in connection with the provision of the Services above a minimum threshold of £25,000 that arise during the Agreement Period.

1.28.2. Once a Sub-Contract has been awarded, the Employer will update the notice on Contracts Finder with the details of the successful sub-contractor.

1.28.3. In addition to any other management information requirements set out in this Agreement, the Employer agrees and acknowledges that it will, at no charge, provide timely, full, accurate and complete SME Management Information ("MI) Reports to the Department which incorporate the following:

(a) The total revenue received directly from the Agreement

(b) The total value of Services under the Agreement that have been sub-contracted (including revenues for non-SMEs/non-VCSEs); and

(c) The total value of sub-contracted revenues to SMEs and VCSEs.

1.28.4. The SME Management Information Reports will be provided in the correct format as required by the Department and any guidance issued by the Department from time to time

1.29. The Employer must obtain an annual report from an external auditor if the aggregate total of all its Sub-Contracts exceeds or is anticipated to exceed £100,000 in any single Funding Year. The calculation of aggregate total of Sub-Contractor delivery must include delivery of Apprenticeships.

Departmental Rights

1.30. In the event that the Employer fails to comply with any of the requirements set out in this Schedule the Department reserves the right to take such remedial action under this Agreement as it considers appropriate in the circumstances, which may include but is not limited to requiring the Employer to terminate an existing Sub-Contract and/ or prohibiting the Employer from entering enter into any new Sub-Contract to deliver the Services under this Agreement.